

Microsoft Privacy Statement

Last updated: June 2026

[What's new ?](#)

We've updated our Privacy Statement to make it easier to read, navigate, and understand, with clearer explanations of how we use data and the choices available to you. More detailed information is available in [What's New](#) .

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Cookies

Most Microsoft websites use cookies (small text files placed on your device) that web servers use in the domain and can retrieve later. We use cookies to store your preferences and settings, help you sign in, provide personalized ads, and analyze site operations. For more information, see the [Cookies and Similar Technologies](#) section of this Privacy Statement.

EU-US data protection frameworks, extended to the UK and Switzerland-US

Microsoft complies with the EU-U.S. data protection frameworks, the UK extension of the EU-U.S. framework, and the Swiss-U.S. framework. For more information, see the [Personal Data Storage and Processing](#) section and [visit the U.S. Department of Commerce's Data Privacy Framework website](#) .

Contact us

If you have a privacy issue, complaint, or question for the Microsoft Privacy Team or Data Protection Officer, please visit our [Privacy Support and Requests](#) page and click the "Contact the Microsoft Privacy Team or Microsoft Data Protection Officer" menu item. For more information about Microsoft contacts, including Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited, see the " [How to Contact Us](#)" section of this Privacy Statement.

Microsoft takes your privacy very seriously. This privacy statement explains what personal data we process, how we process it, and for what purposes.

Microsoft offers a wide range of products, including server products used to help run businesses worldwide, devices that customers use at home, software that students use in school, and services that developers use to create and host new products. References to Microsoft products in this statement include Microsoft services, websites, applications, software, servers, and devices.

Please read the product-specific details in this privacy statement for more information. This statement applies to interactions between Microsoft and you, the Microsoft products listed below, and other Microsoft products that trigger the display of this statement.

You will find details about the personal data collected from children in the section [Data Collection from Children](#) . It may be helpful for young people to start with the [Privacy for Young People](#) page .

For individuals residing in the United States, please refer to our [US Data Privacy Notice](#) (including information regarding data collection) and [Consumer Health Data Privacy Policy](#) for additional information about your rights and the processing of your personal data.

For more information about how we handle data from organizations that use our products and services, such as organizations and educational institutions, please see the "Products for organizations and developers" section of this Privacy Statement. If you use a Microsoft product or a Microsoft account provided by your organization, please see the " [Products provided by your organization](#)" and "[Microsoft account](#)" sections for more information.

The personal data we collect

Microsoft collects data from users through your interactions with us and your use of our products. We collect data to operate, improve, and provide you with the best possible experiences. Some data is provided directly by you, while other data is collected based on how you use our products and communicate with us. The types

and amount of data we collect depend on how you interact with Microsoft, your choices, the privacy settings and features you use, and applicable law.

The data we collect may include the following:

Name and contact details . Your first and last name, email address, postal address, telephone number and other similar contact information.

Account credentials . Information used to access your account, such as username, password, and password hints.

Demographic data . Details about you, such as your age, gender, country, and language preference.

Payment details . Details needed to process payments, including credit card numbers and security codes.

Subscription and license data . Details about your product subscriptions, licenses, and other rights.

Interactions . Information about your use of Microsoft products, including the features you use, searches, commands entered, error reports, and support requests.

- **Device and usage data** . Data about your device and the features of the product you are using, hardware and software details, product performance, and your settings. For example:
 - **Payment and account history** .
 - **Navigation history** .
 - **Device, connectivity, and configuration data** . For example, IP addresses, device identifiers, nearby networks, and other information about the operating systems and other software installed on your device.
 - **Error reports ("crash dumps") and performance data** . This typically includes details of the software, hardware, and file content related to an error, as well as other software on your device.
 - **Troubleshooting and support data** . Data you provide when you contact Microsoft for help. For example, contact or authentication information, the content of your communications with Microsoft, the status of your device, the products in question, and other details that help us provide support. Phone calls or chat sessions with our representatives may be monitored and recorded.

- **Bot usage data** . Interactions with bots and skills available through Microsoft products, including bots and skills provided by third parties.
- **Interests and favorites** . The preferences and interests that you share (such as favorite sports teams, preferred programming languages, or cities for weather or traffic) or that we infer from your activity, such as your activity on sites that use our technology for advertising purposes.
- **Content consumption** . Information about the multimedia content you access through our products, such as television, video, music or audio, applications and games.
- **Searches and commands** . The search queries and commands that you provide in Microsoft products, for example, interactions with a chatbot.
- **Voice data** . Also called "voice clips," these include spoken requests, voice commands, or dictation, and may include background sounds. [Learn more about how Microsoft uses and protects voice data in its speech recognition technologies](#) .
- **Text, inking, and data entry** . Data and related information that you provide by typing, inking, or using touch interaction in Microsoft products.
- **Images** . Images and associated data, such as image metadata. For example, we collect the image you provide when you use a Bing service that supports images or when you upload an image to Microsoft Copilot.
- **Contacts and relationships** . Data about your contacts and relationships if you use a product to manage your contacts, share information or communicate with others, or to improve your productivity.
- **Traffic data** . Data relating to your use of Microsoft communication services, including the people you have contacted and the date of these exchanges.
- **Social data** . Information about your interactions and relationships with other people, such as likes, events, and other types of participation.
- **Location data** . Data about the location of your device, which can be precise (usually based on GPS, cell tower or Wi-Fi access point location) or imprecise (e.g., inferred from an IP address, or the city or postal code listed in your account profile).
- **Biometric data** . Unique data about you obtained through specific technical processing related to your physical, physiological, or behavioral characteristics, in order to verify or confirm your identity. For example, you can use your fingerprint or facial recognition to sign in to your Windows device via Windows Hello (for more information, see the [Windows Hello](#) section below).

Our collection and use of biometric data depends on the products and features you use and your consent.

- **Other entry** . Data generated during the use of devices or participation in events, such as the buttons you press on an Xbox controller or other activity data, or information you provide when registering for or participating in an in-person event.

Content . Information contained in files and messages, emails, chats, calls, meetings, photos, documents, and other media that you create or share using Microsoft products.

Video and audio recordings in Microsoft premises . Recordings of events and activities in Microsoft buildings, retail spaces and other locations, which may include your image and voice data.

Comments and ratings . Information you provide in your comments, surveys or product reviews.

The product sections below describe the data collection practices applicable to the use of these products.

We also receive data from Microsoft affiliates, subsidiaries, and third parties. We protect data collected from third parties in accordance with the practices described in this statement and by applying any additional restrictions imposed by the data source. These third-party sources, which may vary over time, include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Data brokers from whom we purchase demographic and contact information to supplement the data we collect.
- Services that make user-generated content accessible to others from their service, for example, reviews of local businesses or public posts on social networks.
- communication services, including email providers and social networks, if you give us permission to access your data on these third-party services or networks;
- service providers who help us determine the location of your device;
- Partners with whom we engage in joint marketing activities.
- developers who create experiences through or for Microsoft products;
- third parties that provide experiences using Microsoft products.
- Publicly accessible sources, such as open datasets from the public, academic, and private sectors.

You have a choice regarding the data you share. When asked to provide personal data, you can refuse. You can also use web browser, product, or operating system controls to limit or prevent certain types of automatic data collection. However, most of our products require some personal data because it allows us to provide and manage a service for you. If you choose not to provide the required data or not to allow us to collect it, you will not be able to use the product or its associated features. Similarly, if we need to collect personal data as required by law or to enter into or perform a contract with you, and you do not provide that data, we will not be able to enter into or perform the contract. If providing data is optional and you choose not to share your personal data, you will not be able to access certain features that use it, such as personalization, which will not work for you.

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How we use personal data

Microsoft uses the data we collect to provide you with rich and interactive experiences. We also use data to conduct our business, including analyzing our performance, complying with legal obligations, developing our workforce, and conducting research. Microsoft is committed to keeping your personal data secure and uses a variety of security technologies and procedures to protect it from unauthorized access, use, or disclosure. For example, we store the personal data you provide on computer systems with limited access located in controlled facilities. When we transmit highly sensitive data (such as a credit card number or password) over the internet, we protect it using encryption methods.

More specifically, we use data to:

- **Providing our products** . We use data to operate and provide our products, for example, to process the files you upload to OneDrive so you can access, edit, and manage them. This also includes:
 - **Communications** . We may use your data to contact you for various reasons, for example to inform you about your subscriptions, to tell you when product updates are available, or to contact you about your account.
 - **Personalization** . Many products include personalized features and use automated processes to tailor your experience based on your data and

inferences based on your activities, interests, and location. You can sync settings across devices through your Microsoft account, and many products let you disable personalized features.

- **Product activation** . We use data such as device and application type, location, and unique identifiers to activate products.
- **Transactions** . We use data such as your payment and contact information to complete your transactions with us and deliver your purchases.
- **Customer support** . We use this data to help us troubleshoot problems, repair devices, investigate security incidents, and provide, improve, and ensure the quality of our products, services, and training. We may use voice data from support calls for authentication and security purposes.
- **Safety and security** . We use data to protect the safety and security of our products and customers, for example, by detecting malware and malicious activity. We reserve the right to block communications or remove content that violates our Terms of Use. We use analytics technologies (such as hash matching) to help prevent harm to our systems, our users, and others, as described in our Code of Conduct, and to help prevent child exploitation. This may involve sharing information with the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) and law enforcement agencies. We also use tools to detect and stop the misuse of video calling features to produce and share images of child sexual exploitation and abuse by high-risk users. To learn more about our efforts to prevent and detect child exploitation, [click here](#) .
- **Providing age-appropriate experiences** . We use information associated with your Microsoft account to provide more age-appropriate experiences across our services. This may include information you provide, such as your date of birth or the settings you choose in your account; information about your use of Microsoft services, such as how you interact with features, content, and products; or information from partners or verification services, such as age range signals received from app stores. We use this information to help us apply age-appropriate protections, settings, and experiences. When we apply age-related protections, we typically apply them across all

Microsoft services connected to your account so that your experience is consistent.

- **Troubleshooting and updates** . We use data to troubleshoot performance issues, develop updates and security patches, and notify users of product updates. This may include using automated systems to detect security issues.
- **Product improvement and development**
 - **Product improvement** . We use data to improve our products, including adding new features. For example, we use error reports to improve security features, queries and clicks in Bing to improve search results, and voice data to develop and improve the accuracy of speech recognition.
 - **Product Development** . We use data to develop new products. For example, we use data, often anonymized, to better understand our customers' computing and productivity needs, and to train and refine AI models, which can shape new product development. As part of our efforts to improve and develop our products, we may use your data to develop, train, and refine our AI models, including large language models (LLMs). Learn more [here](#) .
- **Marketing, advertising and promotions**
 - **Promotional communications** . We use data to send you promotional messages. See the section "How to access and control your personal data" for more information on managing your contact details, email subscriptions, and promotional messages.
 - **Relevant offers** . Microsoft uses data to provide you with information about products and offers that may interest you, such as new games based on your activity.
 - **Advertising** . We use data for advertising on Microsoft and third-party properties, sometimes using automated processes to make ads more relevant. Microsoft does not use what you say in emails, person-to-person conversations, video calls, or voice messages, nor does it use your personal files, photos, or documents to target you. For more information, see the Advertising section.
 - **Prize promotions and events** . We use your data to manage competitions and promotional events, and to select winners. For example, if you enter a competition, we may use your data to select a winner and provide you with the prize if you have won.

- **How the activity works**
 - **Business reports and operations** . We use data to analyze and improve our business, make informed decisions, and report on our company's performance.
 - **Protection of rights and property** . We use data to detect and prevent fraud, resolve disputes, enforce contracts, and protect our property. For example, we use data to confirm software licenses to reduce piracy and combat fraud. We may use automated processes to detect and prevent activities that violate our rights and the rights of third parties, such as fraud.
 - **Legal compliance** . We process data to comply with applicable laws. For example, we use our customers' ages to help us meet our obligations regarding the protection of children's privacy.
- **Search** . With appropriate safeguards for the rights and freedoms of individuals, we use data for research purposes, including AI and Machine Learning, in the public interest and for scientific purposes.

We combine data collected in different contexts or obtained from third parties to provide you with a smoother, more consistent, and personalized experience, to make informed business decisions, and for other legitimate purposes. For example, the Microsoft Store uses information about the apps and services you use to make personalized app recommendations. We use technological and procedural security measures to prevent certain data combinations; for example, we store data collected from unauthenticated users separately from account information that directly identifies you, such as your name, email address, or phone number.

Our processing of personal data involves both automated and manual (human) methods, which often work together. For example, to create, train, and improve the accuracy of our automated systems such as AI, we manually review certain results against the underlying data.

Legal basis for processing

We process your personal data with your consent and/or when necessary to provide the products you use, conduct our business, comply with our contractual and legal obligations, protect the security of our systems and customers, or pursue our legitimate interests or those of third parties. The reasons we use your data are described here and in the section " [Reasons for Disclosure of Personal Data](#) ." Our legal basis for processing may vary depending on how we process your data and the products or services involved. When we rely on legitimate interests, we examine

those interests and balance them with your rights and freedoms, and we only process your data if those interests do not override yours.

Personal data retention

Microsoft retains personal data for as long as necessary to provide the products and services you use and to process the transactions you request. We also retain personal data for other legitimate purposes, such as operating our business, complying with our contractual and legal obligations, improving and developing our products and services, protecting the security of our systems and customers, and resolving disputes. Because these needs may vary depending on the types of data and the context surrounding our interactions with you or your use of our products, actual retention periods may vary significantly. For more information, please refer to the product documentation.

The criteria used to determine retention periods are as follows:

- The purposes for which we use the information. For example, when you store a document in OneDrive, we retain the data until you actively delete it.
- The nature and sensitivity of the information. For example, we apply a shorter retention period for precise geolocation information.
- Legal, contractual, and other similar obligations to which we are subject, including data retention laws, government orders to retain data relevant to an investigation, or data retained in connection with litigation. Conversely, we will remove illegal content when required by law.

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Reasons why we disclose personal data

We disclose your personal data with your consent if necessary to complete any transaction or provide any product you have requested or authorized, or if necessary to fulfill any other purpose described in the section "[How we use personal data](#)". For example, we share your content with third parties when you ask us to do so, such as when you email a friend or link accounts to another service.

If you use a work or school account or a Microsoft product provided by an organization you are affiliated with, such as an employer or school, we disclose certain data, such as interaction data and diagnostic data, to allow your organization to manage the products.

We will disclose payment information to banks and other payment processors, as well as financial service providers, to fulfill your purchases from us and to prevent fraud and reduce credit risk. If you register a payment method, such as a card, on an account used by you and other Microsoft account holders, your purchase receipts may be accessible to anyone else who uses and has access to that same payment method to make a purchase from Microsoft.

When you allow push notifications for Microsoft products or apps on a non-Windows device, we may send data to a third-party notification provider to deliver those push notifications. Your device's push notification services are governed by their own terms and service-specific privacy policies.

We also disclose personal data for digital advertising purposes. See the [Advertising](#) section for more information on how personal data is used for advertising purposes.

In addition, we share personal data between affiliates and subsidiaries controlled by Microsoft, including for the purposes described in this Privacy Statement. We also provide personal data to suppliers or agents working on our behalf for the purposes described in this statement, such as companies we engage to provide customer service support. These companies must comply with our data privacy and security standards and may not use your data for any other purpose. We may also disclose personal data in connection with corporate transactions such as mergers or asset sales.

Finally, we retain, access, transfer, disclose and store your personal data, including your content (such as the content of your emails in Outlook.com or files in OneDrive), when we have a good belief that it is necessary to perform one of the following actions:

- when required by applicable law or to comply with valid legal processes, including those from law enforcement authorities and other government agencies.
- Protect the security of our customers, organizations and the public – for example, to prevent spam, stop attempts at defragmentation or other damage, or to detect, prevent and combat dangerous or non-compliant behavior, including the creation and sharing of dangerous or non-compliant content.
- to operate and ensure the security of our products, including preventing or stopping an attack on our computer systems or networks;

- Protecting Microsoft's rights or property, including enforcing the terms governing the use of our services. If we receive information indicating that our services are being used for trafficking in stolen properties, we may refer the matter to law enforcement.

For more information about the data we disclose in response to requests from law enforcement and other government agencies, please see our [Law Enforcement Requests Report](#) .

It's important to note that some of our products contain links (or other means of access) to third-party products whose privacy policies differ from Microsoft's. For example, third-party applications or extensions that run on a Windows or Edge browser may collect personal data according to their own practices. If you provide personal data to any of these products, your data is governed by their privacy policy.

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How to access and control your personal data

You can make choices about how Microsoft collects and uses your data. You can control your personal data obtained by Microsoft and exercise your data protection rights by contacting Microsoft or using the various tools we offer (described below).

Microsoft provides you with the following data protection rights, regardless of your location:

- If Microsoft has obtained your consent to use your personal data, you can **withdraw that consent** at any time.
- You have the **right to be informed** about the collection and use of your personal data.
- You can request access **to** your personal data, **its erasure** or **its rectification** .
- If you wish **to transfer** your data to another location, you can do so using the tools provided by Microsoft or, if none are available, you can contact Microsoft for assistance.
- You can also **object to or limit** Microsoft's use of your personal data. For example, you can object at any time to our use of your personal data for direct marketing purposes or when we are performing a task in the public interest or pursuing our legitimate interests or those of a third party.

In some cases, your ability to access or control your personal data will be limited, to the extent required or permitted by applicable law. If your organization (for example, your employer, school, or service provider) gives you access to Microsoft products and manages your use of them, contact them to learn more about how you can access and control your personal data.

The most useful tools for accessing and controlling the personal data Microsoft has collected depend on our interactions with you and your use of our products. Here is a general list of the tools we provide to help you control your personal data; specific products may offer additional controls. See the product-specific sections below for more information on how you can access your data through other features built into the product.

- **Bing.** If you're signed in to Bing with your Microsoft account, you can view and clear your stored search and chat history on your [Privacy Dashboard](#) . If you're not signed in, you can view and clear the search history associated with your device in your [Bing settings](#) .
- **Microsoft Copilot and Microsoft 365 Copilot** . If you are signed in to Microsoft Copilot or Microsoft 365 Copilot with your Microsoft account, you can view, access, export, and delete your Copilot activity history from your [Privacy Dashboard](#) . You can also use the built-in controls to manage your data on the Microsoft Copilot [website](#) or app.
- **Microsoft account.** You can visit the [Microsoft account website](#) if you want to access, edit, or delete your account profile and payment information, change your password, add security information, or close your account.
- **Microsoft Privacy Dashboard** . You can control some of the data processed by Microsoft through your Microsoft account on the [Microsoft Privacy Dashboard](#) . For example, you can view and delete browsing, search, and location data associated with your Microsoft account.
- **Microsoft Store.** You can access your Microsoft Store profile and account information by visiting the [Microsoft Store](#) and selecting **View account** or **Order history** .
- **Microsoft Teams for personal use** You can find out how to export or delete Teams data related to your personal Microsoft account by visiting this [page](#) .
- **OneDrive.** You can view, download and delete your files and photos in OneDrive by signing in to your [OneDrive](#) account .
- **Outlook.com.** You can download your emails from [Outlook.com](#) by signing in to your account and accessing your **data and privacy** settings .

- **Skype** . If you want to access, change, or delete certain Skype profile information or change your password, [sign in to your account](#) . If you want to export your Skype chat history and files shared on Skype, you can [request a copy](#) .
- **Xbox** . If you use the Xbox Network or Xbox.com, you can view or change your personal data, including billing and account information, privacy settings, and online security and data sharing preferences, by accessing [My Xbox](#) on the Xbox console or at Xbox.com.

Some personal data processed by Microsoft is not accessible or controllable through the tools described above. If you wish to access or control personal data processed by Microsoft that is not available through the tools described above or directly through the Microsoft products you use, you can contact Microsoft at the address in the " [How to contact us](#)" section or by visiting our [Support and Privacy Requests](#) page .

Your communication preferences

You can choose whether or not to receive promotional communications from Microsoft via email, text message, postal mail, or phone. To opt out of promotional emails or text messages, follow the instructions in the message. For more options, including managing contact information, Microsoft-wide contact preferences, email subscriptions, and sharing information with partners, sign in to your personal Microsoft account and visit your [communication permissions](#) page . If you don't have a Microsoft account, you can manage your Microsoft email contact preferences using this [web form](#) . These choices do not apply to mandatory service communications or other informational messages, which have their own unsubscribe methods.

Your advertising choices

To opt out of receiving personalized ads from Microsoft (including Xandr), visit our [Personalized ads and offers page](#) . You can also visit our [third-party advertising partners](#) and opt out of data sharing for personalized ads on our [Third-Party Ad Settings page](#) . When you're signed in to your Microsoft account, your opt-out choice is associated with your account and applied across all devices when you're signed in. If you're not signed in and choose to opt out, your preference is stored in a browser-specific cookie on your device, which is valid for five years; if you delete cookies, you'll need to opt out again.

For ads controlled by Microsoft in Windows apps, use the opt-out option associated with your personal Microsoft account or disable the advertising ID in Windows settings to refuse personalized ads.

The data used for personalized advertising is also used for other necessary purposes, such as product delivery, analytics, and fraud detection. You will still see ads even if you opt out of personalized ads, but they may be less relevant to you.

You can opt out of personalized advertising from third-party partners by visiting their websites. Please see the [Advertising](#) section below for more information.

Checks performed from the browser

When you use a browser, you can control your personal data using certain features. For example:

- **Cookie control** . You can control the data stored by cookies and withdraw your consent to cookies using the browser-based cookie controls described in the [Cookies](#) section .
- **Tracking protections** . You can control the data that third-party sites can collect about you using Tracking Protection in Microsoft Edge. This feature blocks third-party content, including cookies, from any site you add to the Tracking Protection list.
- **Universal opt-out options** . Microsoft receives and acknowledges the Global Privacy Control (GPC) browser opt-out signal in certain jurisdictions. Microsoft will disable the sharing of your data with third parties for personalized ads and disable the "Share my data with third parties for personalized ads" toggle if we receive a GPC signal from you when you visit our sites.

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Cookies and similar technologies

We use cookies and similar technologies to save and respect your preferences and settings, enable you to log in, deliver personalized ads, combat fraud, analyze the performance of our products, and fulfill other legitimate purposes described below. Some cookies are placed by third parties acting on our behalf. Microsoft apps use additional identifiers, such as the advertising identifier in Windows, for similar purposes. Furthermore, many of our websites and apps also contain web beacons or other similar technologies, as described below.

How we use cookies and similar technologies

- **Preferences and settings** . We use cookies to store and save your choices, such as language settings or advertising preferences, so you don't have to set them up again.
- **Sign-in and authentication** . We use cookies to verify your identity and keep you securely signed in. When you sign in with a Microsoft account, we store a unique identifier and the time you signed in in an encrypted cookie on your device, so you don't have to sign in repeatedly.
- **Security** . We use cookies to protect our products and detect fraud and abuse.
- **Information storage** . We use cookies to remember information you provide, such as items in your shopping cart.
- **Social networks** . Some of our websites include social network cookies, which may allow you to share content with social networking services if you are logged in.
- **Comments** . We use cookies so that you can provide us with feedback on our websites.
- **Personalized advertising** . We use cookies to personalize ads based on your activity. You can opt out as described in the " [How to access and control your personal data](#)" section of this Privacy Statement. We also use web beacons and similar technologies to understand which Microsoft ads displayed on third-party websites and digital platforms encourage visitors to visit our sites and apps. These tools also help us deliver ads on external sites and platforms. See below for more information about web beacons and analytics services.
- **Ad serving and reporting** . We use cookies to record ad impressions and clicks, such as the ads you have seen. This helps us, for example, to avoid showing the same ad repeatedly.
- **Analytics** . We use cookies to collect usage and performance data, such as the number of visitors and other statistics about our websites and products.
- **Performance** . We use cookies to help us understand and improve the performance of our products and websites, for example by collecting data to facilitate load balancing and uptime.

If necessary, we obtain your consent before placing or using optional cookies. Please see the "Cookie Control" section below for more information.

Some of the cookies we commonly use and some of the purposes for which they may be used are listed below. This list is not exhaustive, but it is intended to illustrate

the main purposes for which we place cookies. If you visit one of our websites, the site will place some or all of the following cookies:

- **MSCC** . Contains user choices for most Microsoft sites.
- **MUID, MC1, MSFPC, and ai_user** . These cookies uniquely identify web browsers visiting Microsoft sites. They are used for essential operational purposes. With user consent, these cookies may also be used for advertising purposes.
- **ESTSAUTH, ESTSAUTHLIGHT, ESTSAUTHPERSISTENT** . Helps you authenticate when you sign in with your Microsoft account.
- **MS0** . Identifies a specific session.
- **NAP** . Contains an encrypted version of your country, postal code, age, gender, language and, if applicable, occupation, from your Microsoft account profile.
- **MR** . Resets or refreshes the MUID cookie.
- **x-ms-gateway-slice, ARRAffinity, ARRAffinitySameSite, ASLBSA and ASLBSACORS** . Identifies a gateway for load balancing.
- **TOptOut** . Records your decision not to receive personalized advertising provided by Microsoft. When necessary, we place this cookie by default and delete it when you consent to personalized advertising.
- **ApplicationGatewayAffinity** and **ApplicationGatewayAffinityCORS** . Used for load balancing purposes and to ensure that requests from a user session are handled by the same server.
- **esctx, _RequestVerificationToken, .AspNetCore.Correlation and .AspNetCore.Nonce** contribute to the security of your visit to the website and the stability of the services provided to you by helping to prevent fraud and malicious attacks.

We may also use cookies from other Microsoft affiliates, companies and partners, such as LinkedIn and Xandr.

Third-party cookies

In addition to the cookies Microsoft sets when you visit our websites, we also use third-party cookies to improve the services on our sites. Some third parties may also set cookies when you visit Microsoft sites. For example, when we use companies to provide services on our behalf, such as website analytics, and when companies provide content on our sites, such as videos, news, or advertisements.

These companies use the data they process in accordance with their privacy policies, which may allow them to collect and combine information about your activities on websites, applications, or online services.

The following types of third-party cookies may be used, depending on the context, service or product, and your settings and permissions:

- **Social media cookies.** These cookies help us and third parties to show you ads and content tailored to your interests, based on your social media profiles and your activity on our websites.
- **Analytics cookies.** Third-party analytics cookies collect information about how you use our websites to help us improve them and allow third parties to develop and improve their own products. They may also be used for advertising purposes.
- **Advertising cookies.** Advertising cookies record the ads you have seen, the ads you have clicked on, or the purchases you have made after clicking. They show you relevant ads, for example, ads based on your social media interests and website browsing history.
- **Essential cookies.** Required cookies enable basic website functionality, such as login, preferences, shopping carts, performance, and security.

For a list of third parties that place cookies on our websites, please see our [Third-Party Cookie Inventory](#) . On some of our websites, a list of third parties is available directly on the site and may not be included in our [Third-Party Cookie Inventory](#) . Consult the third-party websites or privacy notices for more information about their privacy practices regarding the cookies that may be set on our websites.

Cookie control

Most browsers automatically accept cookies but provide controls to allow you to block or delete them. For example, in Microsoft Edge, you can block or delete cookies by selecting **Settings** > **Privacy and services** > **Clear browsing data** > **Cookies and other site data** . For more information about how to view, block, or delete your cookies in Microsoft Edge, see our [Manage cookies in Microsoft Edge](#) page . If you are using a different browser, refer to that browser's instructions. If you choose to block cookies, you will not be able to sign in to or use some of these features, and preferences that depend on cookies will be lost. If you delete your cookies, settings and preferences controlled by those cookies, including advertising preferences, will be deleted and will need to be recreated.

Where necessary, we obtain your consent before placing or using optional cookies that are not (i) strictly necessary to provide the website or (ii) intended to facilitate communication. We separate these optional cookies by purpose, including advertising, analytics, and social media. Where consent is required, you can adjust your choices by clicking "Manage cookies" in the website footer or via the settings available on the website. Some features of Microsoft products rely on cookies.

Additional privacy controls that may impact cookies, including Microsoft browsers' tracking protection feature, are described in the [How to access and control your personal data](#) section of this privacy statement.

Web beacons and analytics services

Some Microsoft web pages use electronic tags called web beacons to deliver cookies, count visitors, and provide products. We also use web beacons or similar technologies in our communications to determine whether you open and respond to them.

We sometimes place our web beacons on other companies' websites or advertisements to help us understand how interactions with Microsoft ads lead to actions, such as purchases, or to learn more about your activity on partner sites related to Microsoft products or services.

Microsoft products often include web beacons or similar technologies from third-party analytics providers. These providers help us compile statistics about our campaigns and operations. They may set or read their own cookies or identifiers on your device to collect information about your online activity on websites and apps. However, we prohibit these providers from using web beacons on our sites to collect or access information that directly identifies you, such as your name or email address. You can opt out of data collection or use by some of these analytics providers by visiting one of the following websites: [Adjust](#) , [AppsFlyer](#) , [Clicktale](#) , [Flurry Analytics](#) , [Google Analytics](#) (requires a browser add-on), [Kissmetrics](#) , [Mixpanel](#) , [Nielsen](#) , [Acuity Ads](#) , [WebTrends](#) , or [Optimizely](#) .

Other similar technologies

Our products may also use other similar technologies to store and read data files on your computer. Generally, this is done to save your preferences or improve speed and performance by storing certain files locally. These technologies may also store a unique identifier for your computer, which can then be used to track your behavior.

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Microsoft account

A **Microsoft account** is a personal account that lets you sign in to Microsoft products and those of certain partners. This account includes personal data such as your login credentials, name and contact information, payment information, device and usage data, contacts, information about your activities, and your interests and favorites. Signing in to your Microsoft account helps personalize your experience, provides consistent experiences across products and devices, enables cloud storage, allows you to make payments with saved payment methods, and activates other features.

A **work or school account**, also called a Microsoft Entra ID, is an account provided and managed by your organization, such as your employer or school. You can use it to sign in to Microsoft products and third-party products that your organization provides. If you sign in to Microsoft products with a work or school account, please note:

- Your organization controls your account and can access and process your data, including your communications, files, and content in the products you use with your account.
- Your use of these products is subject to your organization's policies. Review your organization's privacy and security policies before using your work or school account for personal purposes.
- If you lose access to your work or school account, for example if you change employers, you may also lose access to products or content purchased or viewed with that account.
- If you use a work or school email address to create a Microsoft account, your organization can access your data associated with your Microsoft account.
- Microsoft is not responsible for your organization's privacy or security practices, which may differ from our own standards.
- Address all privacy-related questions or requests, such as accessing, correcting, or deleting your data, to your administrator. For more information about your rights, see the section [Products Provided by Your Organization – End User Notices](#).

Contact your organization if you are unsure whether your account is a work or school account.

A third-party account is a Microsoft account that you or your service provider, such as an internet or cable TV provider, creates and that is associated with your email address and your service provider's domain. Your service provider controls your account, including the ability to access or delete it. You should carefully review the terms provided by the third party to better understand what the service provider can do with your account and data.

Your Microsoft account. The data associated with your Microsoft account and the use of that data depend on how you use the account.

- **Create your Microsoft account** . When you create a Microsoft account, you'll be asked to provide some personal information, and we'll assign you a unique ID. For some products, such as those involving payments, a real name is required, but many products can be used without one. Information such as your display name, email address, and phone number can help other users find you on Microsoft products, for example, on Microsoft Teams for personal use. In some cases, you might need to switch to a personal email address to continue accessing consumer products like the Xbox Network.
- **Sign in to your Microsoft account** . When you sign in to your Microsoft account, we record details such as the date and time, the product viewed, the sign-in name, account and device identifiers, IP address, and information about the operating system and browser.
- **Signing in to Microsoft products** improves personalization, provides a consistent experience across products, allows access to cloud storage, and lets you make payments using information stored in your account, as well as access other settings and features. Information saved in your account may be available in Microsoft products. If you add your account to a Windows device (version 8 or later), Windows will automatically sign you in to Microsoft products on that device. When you're signed in, some products will display your name or username and profile picture (if you have one) in Microsoft products, communications, and public posts. [Learn more about your Microsoft account, your data, and your choices](#) .
- **Connecting to third-party products** . If you connect to a third-party product or make payments to third-party merchants using your Microsoft account, Microsoft shares data with the third party as needed, including your account version number and whether your account has been deactivated. Third parties may use or share your data in accordance with their own privacy policies. You

should carefully review the privacy policies of each product or merchant you use to understand how your data will be handled.

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Collection of data relating to children

Microsoft offers many products and services that children and adults can use, although children and adults won't always have access to all the features and services available to adult users. Some of these features will be disabled by default or unavailable to younger users. When a child is under 13 years old, or older if required by their region, the child needs parental or guardian consent to create a Microsoft account. Parents can change or revoke consent at any time.

Microsoft offers parental control tools that allow parents to connect their children's accounts to a family group. Microsoft accounts created using parental consent are automatically added to the parent's family group. As the organizer of a Microsoft family group, the parent or guardian can manage their child's information and settings on their [Family Safety](#) page and view and delete a child's data on their [Privacy Dashboard](#). Parents of Xbox users have additional controls through the Xbox Family Settings app.

[Learn more](#)

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Storage and processing of personal data

The personal data collected by Microsoft may be stored and processed in your region, the United States, and any other jurisdiction where Microsoft or its affiliates, subsidiaries, or service providers operate facilities. Microsoft Corporation operates major data centers in Australia, Austria, Brazil, Canada, Finland, France, Germany, Hong Kong SAR, India, Ireland, Japan, Luxembourg, Malaysia, the Netherlands, South Africa, South Africa, South Korea, Singapore, the United Kingdom, the United States, and the United States. Typically, the primary storage location is in your region or the United States, often with a backup in a data center in another region. Storage locations are chosen to operate and deliver our services efficiently, improve performance, and create redundancies to protect data in the event of an outage or other problem.

We transfer personal data from the country of origin to other countries, including those that may not offer the same level of data protection as determined by the European Commission or your local data protection authority. In such cases, we implement safeguards, such as standard contractual clauses approved by the European Commission, to protect your rights and ensure your data remains secure. The EU has also determined that certain non-EU countries provide an "adequate" level of personal data protection, similar to EU law. For more information on EU adequacy decisions and other methods of protecting personal data in countries where Microsoft processes data, please visit [the European Commission's website](#) .

Refer to the section Reasons why we share personal data for more information about Microsoft's data sharing practices, including when we transfer data to another country.

Microsoft Corporation complies with the EU-US Data Protection Framework (EU-US DPF), the UK extension of the EU-US Data Protection Framework, and the Swiss-US Data Protection Framework (Swiss-US DPF), as defined by the U.S. Department of Commerce. Microsoft Corporation has certified to the U.S. Department of Commerce that it adheres to the principles of the EU-US Personal Data Protection Framework (EU-US DPF Principles) with respect to the processing of personal data received from the European Union under the EU-US DPF and from the United Kingdom (and Gibraltar) under the UK extension of the EU-US DPF. Microsoft Corporation has certified to the U.S. Department of Commerce that it adheres to the principles of the Swiss-American Data Protection Framework (Swiss-American DPF Principles) with respect to the processing of personal data received from Switzerland under the Swiss-American DPF.

In the context of a subsequent transfer, Microsoft Corporation is responsible for the processing of personal data it receives under the DPF and then transfers to a third party acting as an agent on our behalf. Microsoft Corporation remains liable under the DPF if our agent processes such personal data in a manner inconsistent with the DPF, unless Microsoft Corporation can prove that we are not responsible for the event giving rise to the harm. In the event of a conflict between the terms of this Privacy Statement and the EU-U.S. DPF Principles and/or the Swiss-U.S. DPF Principles, the DPF Principles shall prevail. To learn more about the Data Privacy Framework (DPF) and to view our certification, [visit the U.S. Department of Commerce's Data Privacy Infrastructure website](#) . Microsoft Corporation's controlled U.S. subsidiaries, as identified in our self-certification submission, also adhere to the DPF

Principles. For more information, see the list of [US Microsoft entities covered by the Data Privacy Framework certification](#) .

If you have a question or complaint regarding Microsoft's participation in the DPF frameworks, we encourage you to contact us through our [Support and Privacy Requests](#) page . For any complaints related to the DPF frameworks that Microsoft cannot resolve directly, we have chosen to cooperate with the relevant EU data protection authority, or with a panel established by the European data protection authorities, to resolve disputes with EU individuals; with the UK Information Commissioner to resolve disputes with UK individuals; and with the Swiss Federal Data Protection and Information Commissioner (FDPIC) to resolve disputes with Swiss individuals. Contact us if you would like us to direct you to the contact points at your data protection authority. As the DPF principles explain in more detail, mandatory arbitration is available to handle residual complaints that have not been resolved through other means. Microsoft is subject to the investigative and sanctioning powers of the U.S. Federal Trade Commission (FTC).

Individuals whose personal data is protected under Japan's Personal Information Protection Act should refer to the article on the [website of the Japanese Commission for the Protection of Personally Identifiable Information](#) (published in Japanese only) for information on the Commission's review of certain personal data protection systems in specific countries. For individuals in Japan, click [here](#) for information on the handling of information under the Telecommunications Act (Japanese only).

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Advertisement

Advertising helps us provide, support, and improve some of our products. Microsoft does not use what you say in email, human conversation, video calls, or voicemail, nor does it use your documents, photos, or other personal files stored on your device or in the cloud to target you. We use other data for advertising on Microsoft and third-party properties.

Ads may appear based on your current interaction with us, such as your Copilot conversations (including files you share); your current location; transactions; product usage; search queries; or the content you view. For example, if you search for "pizzas in Seattle" on Bing, you may see ads for local Seattle restaurants in your search results.

Where permitted, ads may also be personalized using information about you collected over time, such as demographics, location, search queries, interests, purchase history, favorites, use of our products and sites, and information from advertisers and partners. We call this type of advertising "personalized advertising." For example, viewing gaming content on [xbox.com](https://www.xbox.com) may lead to you seeing gaming ads on MSN later.

Personalized ads use cookies associated with information we collect when your browser interacts with our sites (such as your IP address). Cookie data will not be used for personalized ads if you opt out of receiving them. To learn more about how Microsoft uses data to deliver personalized ads and to opt out of receiving personalized ads from Microsoft, see our [Personalized Ads Offers & Settings](#) page , and our "Opt Out" section below.

Some products have their own personalized advertising settings. For example, if you're signed in to your Microsoft account, we use your online activity in Microsoft Edge to show you personalized ads, subject to your privacy settings. You can adjust your Edge privacy settings under **Microsoft Edge > Settings > Privacy and services** . In Windows, if Advertising ID is enabled in your Windows privacy settings, third parties can access and use it to serve ads in apps.

For more information about our use of advertising-related data:

- **Advertising industry best practices and commitments** . Microsoft participates in industry self-regulatory programs and adheres to the [NAI Self-Regulatory Framework](#) . We also adhere to the following self-regulatory programs:
 - In the United States: [Digital Advertising Alliance \(DAA\)](#)
 - In Europe: [European Interactive Digital Advertising Alliance \(EDAA\)](#)
 - In Canada: [Advertisers' Choice: Digital Advertising Alliance of Canada \(DAAC\)](#) / [Ad Choice: Digital Advertising Alliance of Canada \(DAAC\)](#)
- **Children and advertising** . We do not show personalized ads to children whose date of birth listed in their Microsoft account proves they are under 18.
- **Sensitive Data** : Microsoft Advertising does not collect, process, or disclose personal data that qualifies as "sensitive data" under applicable U.S. state data privacy laws for the purpose of providing personalized ads.

Opt-out pending . To opt out of receiving personalized ads from Microsoft, visit our Personalized [ads and offers page](#) . To opt out of sharing data with third parties for personalized ads, visit our [Third-Party Ad Settings](#) page . When you're signed in to

your Microsoft account, your opt-out choice is associated with your account and applied across all devices when you're signed in. If you're not signed in and choose to opt out, your preference is stored in a browser-specific cookie on your device, which is valid for five years; if you delete cookies, you'll need to opt out again.

Microsoft receives and takes into account the Global Privacy Control (GPC) browser opt-out signal in certain jurisdictions. Microsoft will disable the sharing of your data with third parties for personalized ads and disable the "Share my data with third parties for personalized ads" toggle if we receive a GPC signal from you when you visit our sites.

Data collected from or shared with other advertising companies . Advertisers sometimes include their own web beacons or those of their other advertising partners in the ads we display, which allows them to set and read their own cookies. In some cases, we share reports with advertisers about the data we have collected on their sites or in their ads. In addition, Microsoft Corporation partners with Xandr, a Microsoft company, and third-party advertising companies to help provide some of our advertising services, and we also allow other third-party advertising companies to display ads on our sites. These third parties may also place cookies on your devices and collect information about your online activity on websites or online services. These companies currently include, but are not limited to: [Facebook](#) , [Media.net](#) , [Outbrain](#) , [Taboola](#) , and [Yahoo](#) . For more information, see our Cookies and Similar Technologies section.

We may share the data we collect with internal and external partners, including Xandr, other subsidiaries and affiliates, Yahoo, Facebook, and The Trade Desk, to help us make the ads you see in our products and theirs, or on other sites, more relevant to you. People in the UK can learn more about The Trade Desk's advertising practices in the UK and opt out of The Trade Desk's processing of their data [here](#) . Many of these companies participate in [the DAA \(US\)](#) , EDAA (Europe), or DAAC (Canada), which provide industry-wide opt-out tools for advertising targeting by participating companies.

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Other important information about privacy

Diagnostic data

Many Microsoft products collect diagnostic data to secure and keep our services up to date; to verify that they function as expected; to detect, diagnose, and fix problems; and to improve our products. Diagnostic data may include information about incidents, performance, and your use of our products.

There are two levels of diagnostic data: mandatory diagnostic data and optional diagnostic data. Products that collect diagnostic data always collect the required diagnostic data, but you can control whether you wish to send us optional diagnostic data.

- **Mandatory diagnostic data** . The minimum data required to help keep our products, applications, and services secure, up-to-date, and functioning as expected. This includes information about your device, the Microsoft software you use, settings, features, and performance.
- **Optional Diagnostic Data:** Additional diagnostic data about your use of a device, application, accessory, or other products and services, which helps us improve our products and detect and resolve problems. This may also include data about the websites you visit, device activity (sometimes also called usage), and enhanced error reporting.

For more information about the use of diagnostic data, see the [Microsoft Privacy Report](#) .

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Pre-commercial or free versions

Microsoft offers products and features in preview, Insider, beta, or other free versions ("previews") to allow you to evaluate them while providing data about your use of the product, including your feedback and device and usage data. As a result, pre-release versions may automatically collect additional data, have fewer controls, or employ different privacy and security measures than those typically found in our products.

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Changes to this privacy statement

We update this privacy statement as needed and to provide greater transparency, for example in response to feedback from customers, regulators, industry or other stakeholders; changes to our products; changes to our business or data processing strategies; or changes to applicable laws.

When we publish changes to this policy, we will update the "Last Updated" date at the top of the policy and describe the changes on the [Change History](#) page . If there are significant changes to the policy, such as a change to the purposes for processing personal data that is inconsistent with the original purpose of the collection, we will notify you of the change before it takes effect. We encourage you to review this privacy statement regularly for updates.

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How to contact us

If you have a privacy issue, complaint, or question for the Microsoft Privacy Team or your regional Data Protection Officer, visit our [Privacy Support and Requests](#) page and then click the "Contact the Microsoft Privacy Team or Microsoft Data Protection Officer" menu. We will respond to questions or concerns within 30 days, or as otherwise required by law. You can also report an issue or file a complaint with a data protection authority or other competent authority.

Where Microsoft is the data controller, unless otherwise stated, Microsoft Corporation and, for those residing in a country within the European Economic Area, the United Kingdom, and Switzerland, Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited, are the data controllers of the personal data we collect through the products subject to this statement. Our addresses are as follows:

- Microsoft Privacy, Microsoft Corporation, One Microsoft Way, Redmond, Washington 98052, USA. Telephone: +1 (425) 882 8080.

- Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited, Attn: Data Protection Officer, One Microsoft Place, South County Business Park, Leopardstown, Dublin 18, Ireland. Telephone: +353 1 706 3117.

To find the Microsoft subsidiary in your country or region, consult the list of [Microsoft offices worldwide](#) .

The representative of Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited within the meaning of Art. 14 of the Swiss Federal Act on Data Protection is Microsoft Schweiz GmbH, The Circle 02, 8058 Zürich-Flughafen, Switzerland.

If you wish to exercise your rights under U.S. data privacy law, you can contact Microsoft at the U.S. address listed above, use our [Support and Privacy Requests](#) page , or call our U.S. toll-free number +1 (844) 931 2038.

If you are located in Brazil, you can contact us. [here](#) within the framework of the LGPD.

If you are a close relative, additional information about managing your deceased loved one's Microsoft accounts is available on our [Support and Privacy Requests](#) page .

If you have a technical or support question, please visit [Microsoft Support](#) to learn more about Microsoft support offerings. If you have a question about your personal Microsoft account password, please visit [Microsoft Account Support](#) .

We offer several ways for you to control the personal data Microsoft has collected and to exercise your data protection rights. You can do this by contacting Microsoft through our [Support and Privacy Requests](#) page or the information above, or by using the various tools we provide. Please see the [How to access and control your personal data](#) section for more details.

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Artificial intelligence and Copilot features

The Microsoft Copilot family of services, products, and solutions leverages AI technologies to generate outputs. Data collection and use by Microsoft may vary depending on the service and features planned for a given scenario.

Our use of AI is governed by the Microsoft [AI Principles](#) and the Microsoft [Responsible AI Standard](#) , and our collection and use of personal data in developing and deploying our AI features are consistent with our commitments described in our Privacy Statement. You can find more information about the tools, practices, and strategies Microsoft has created to adhere to our Responsible AI Principles [here](#) .

The Microsoft Copilot website [and app](#) (available on Windows, Mac, iOS, and Android) are central to the consumer Copilot experience, where you can search the web, create content, and interact with features like Copilot Vision. You can also let Microsoft Copilot interact with other apps, services, and websites to perform actions on your behalf. When you use Microsoft Copilot, it uses your prompts, location, language, and related settings to provide helpful answers and improve services (including delivering relevant ads).

For users signed in in certain markets, Microsoft Copilot may use your chat history to personalize your experience. You can opt out of personalization at any time. Microsoft Copilot also uses prompts and related data to provide and improve services, including relevant advertising. You can manage your prompt history in the product and on the Microsoft Privacy Dashboard, and you can adjust your location, language, and other privacy settings within the product. For more information about these features and your choices, see the [Microsoft Copilot FAQ](#) .

We will also use your chat data to monitor performance, troubleshoot bugs and issues, prevent abuse, and provide and improve Microsoft Copilot. In some markets, this data may help train our AI models in Microsoft Copilot, unless you opt out. Learn more about your choices and data protection [here](#) . Please also see the [Microsoft Copilot Transparency Note](#) for more information about our security practices and our efforts to ensure Copilot adheres to our Responsible AI principles.

Microsoft Copilot also appears in other Microsoft products such as Microsoft Edge and Xbox. In these cases, data is generally used in accordance with the primary uses of each product. For more information, see the Microsoft Edge and Xbox sections of this privacy statement.

If you use Microsoft Copilot in third-party products and services, such as messaging platforms, Microsoft processes your data as described here, but the third party's privacy policies and data processing activities may also apply.

Microsoft 365 Copilot is a consumer-facing Copilot offering available to Microsoft 365 Family and Microsoft 365 Personal subscribers. When Copilot is integrated with

Microsoft 365, it handles data as described in the Productivity and Communications section of this privacy statement.

For Enterprise customers, Microsoft 365 Copilot offers enhanced data protection and customization. Data is collected and used as described in the Enterprise and Developer Products section.

The Copilot features that appear in Microsoft 365 apps as part of a Microsoft 365 Personal, Microsoft 365 Family, or Microsoft 365 Premium subscription offer AI-powered productivity features through real-time conversational experiences. To do this, we apply Large Language Model (LLM) processing to the content you choose to provide in Microsoft 365 apps, including Word, Excel, OneNote, Outlook, and PowerPoint. Copilot in Microsoft 365 is not available for use in Office desktop licenses. When used with available Microsoft 365 apps, Copilot uses the content of your files only when you ask it to perform a specific action on that specific content—for example, when you ask Copilot to help you rewrite a paragraph in a Word document or ask Copilot to generate a to-do list from your notes in OneNote. Similar to connected experiences, required service data is collected during your use of Copilot, which includes information about its operation that is necessary to ensure the security, updating and execution of the underlying service as intended.

For more information, see [Copilot in Microsoft 365 apps for your home: your data and privacy: Microsoft Support](#) and [FAQ on Copilot in Microsoft 365 subscriptions](#) .

Health Copilot is a consumer-facing Copilot offering specifically designed to provide personalized health and wellness support. Health Copilot allows you to upload health-related data, including your personal medical records and data from wearable devices. Health Copilot can use this data, along with your prompts and chat history, to provide you with personalized information and recommendations.

The information you choose to send to Copilot Health is used to provide and operate the Copilot Health service. It is not used to develop or train generative AI models, nor is it used for advertising or marketing purposes. Please see the [Copilot Health FAQs](#) for more information.

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Organization and development products, and products provided by your organization

Enterprise and developer products are Microsoft products and software primarily designed and offered for use by businesses and developers. For example:

- Enterprise online services (referred to as "Online Services" in the [Product Terms](#)) that our Enterprise customers purchase from us, such as Microsoft 365, Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Dynamics 365, and Microsoft Intune.
- Other enterprise and development cloud services, such as Azure PlayFab Services (for more information, see [the Azure PlayFab terms of use](#)).
- Other enterprise and development software, such as Windows Server, SQL Server, Visual Studio, System Center, Azure Stack and open source software like Bot Framework solutions ("Development Software").
- Devices and equipment used for storage infrastructure ("Enterprise Appliances").
- The professional services mentioned in the Product Terms and Conditions that are available with Enterprise Online Services, such as integration services, data migration services, data science services, or services designed to complement existing Enterprise Online Services functionality. For more information, see [Microsoft Professional Services](#).

In the event of a conflict between this Microsoft privacy statement and the terms of any contract between a customer and Microsoft regarding enterprise and developer products, the terms of that contract will prevail.

You can also learn more about the features and settings of our products for businesses and developers, including choices that have consequences for the protection of your personal data or that of your end users, in the product documentation.

When a customer, such as your employer or educational institution, uses, purchases, or subscribes to Enterprise and Developer products, or obtains support for our professional services with these products, Microsoft collects and generates data to provide the service, conduct its business operations, and communicate with the customer. For example:

- When a customer contacts a Microsoft sales representative, we collect their name, contact information, and organizational details to ensure smooth communication.

- When a customer interacts with a Microsoft support professional, we collect device or usage data or error reports to diagnose and resolve issues.
- When Microsoft sends communications to a customer, we use data to personalize the content of the communications.

Enterprise and Developer products allow you to purchase, subscribe to, or use other online products and services from Microsoft or third parties with different privacy practices. These online products and services are governed by their respective privacy statements and policies.

Products provided by your organization – information for end users

If you use a Microsoft product with a work or school account, that organization can:

- Control and administer your Microsoft product and product account, including access to the product or account, and privacy settings for either.
- Accessing and processing your data, including interaction data, diagnostic data, and the content of your communications and files associated with your Microsoft product and accounts.

If your organization provides you with access to Microsoft products, your use of those products is subject to your organization's policies. For privacy-related questions or to exercise your data protection rights, contact your organization's administrator. Microsoft is not responsible for the privacy or security practices of its customers, including your employer or educational institution, which may differ from this privacy statement.

When you use a Microsoft product provided by your company, Microsoft processes your personal data as described in the contract with your organization and as necessary to provide the product and conduct Microsoft's related business activities. If you have questions about how Microsoft processes your data for your company, contact your company. If you have questions about Microsoft's business operations regarding the provision of products to your organization, as described in the Product Terms, contact Microsoft as described in the [How to Contact Us](#) section .

For Microsoft products provided by your primary and secondary school, including Microsoft 365 Education, Microsoft:

- will not collect or use students' personal data beyond what is necessary for authorized educational or school purposes;

- will not sell or rent students' personal data;
- will not use or share students' personal data for advertising or similar commercial purposes, such as delivering personalized advertisements to students;
- will not create a personal profile of a student, except for authorized educational or school purposes or as authorized by the parent, guardian, or student of appropriate age; and
- requires that our suppliers who receive students' personal data in order to provide our educational services implement these same commitments for students' personal data.

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Terms and conditions applicable to Enterprise online services

To provide our Enterprise online services, Microsoft processes, uses, and stores data as described in the [Product Terms](#) , [the Microsoft Products and Services Data Protection Addendum \(DPA Products and Services\)](#) , and the [Microsoft Trust Center](#) .

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Software for businesses and developers, and business devices

Enterprise and developer software and enterprise devices collect data to ensure proper operation and provide the best possible experiences. The types of data collected depend on the features you use, as well as your organization's configuration and settings, but they are generally limited to device and usage data. Customers and, where applicable, end users may have choices regarding the data provided. For example:

- Device and usage data collected during installation or upgrade to troubleshoot technical issues.
- Device and usage data from product use to improve security and functionality.
- Optional error reports are sent to Microsoft to help diagnose problems and provide support.

Microsoft uses this data to provide and improve our products, provide customer support, activate products, communicate with users, and operate our business in accordance with applicable data protection laws.

HoloLens . HoloLens headsets are standalone Windows computers with Wi-Fi connectivity that enable mixed reality experiences for applications and solutions. Microsoft collects diagnostic data to troubleshoot issues and to keep Windows on HoloLens up to date, secure, and functioning properly. Diagnostic data also helps us improve HoloLens and related Microsoft products and services, based on the diagnostic data settings you have chosen for your device. See [Diagnostic Data](#) for more information.

HoloLens also processes and collects data related to the HoloLens experience and devices, including cameras, microphones, and infrared sensors that enable access to movement and voice.

- If you wish, you can use the cameras to automatically log in using your iris. To do this, HoloLens captures an image of your iris and then measures the distances between key points to create and store a unique numerical value that represents you. This data remains within HoloLens and is not shared with anyone, and you can choose to delete this data from HoloLens at any time.
- HoloLens also detects specific hand movements designed for system interactions (such as navigating menus, panning/zooming, and scrolling). This data is processed within your HoloLens device and is not stored.
- HoloLens obtains tracking points based on your environment, allowing it to understand surfaces in space and enabling you to place digital assets on them. There are no images associated with this environmental data, which is stored locally on the HoloLens device. You can choose to delete this data from your HoloLens at any time.

Headset microphones enable voice commands for navigation, app control, or entering search terms. [Learn more about voice data collection](#) .

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Productivity and communication products

Productivity and communications products are applications, software, and services like Microsoft 365, Microsoft Teams, OneDrive, and others that you can use to create, store, and share documents, as well as to communicate with others. These services

use your data based on their features and how you use them—for example, we collect usage data and information about your communications when you use Microsoft Teams, including the time, date, and users involved in the communication. Please see below for more details about these services, their features, and how they use data.

Microsoft 365, Office and other productivity applications

Microsoft 365 is a subscription-based suite of productivity applications and services, including Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, and OneNote, among others. Office is the one-time purchase version of these applications, available for PC or Mac, and includes Access and Publisher. Microsoft 365 and Office consist of client software applications and connected online services (or web applications in the case of Microsoft 365 for the web) that span multiple platforms and offer many interconnected experiences. For more details about Outlook, see the [Outlook](#) section of this privacy statement.

You can manage your privacy by accessing the privacy controls in your Microsoft 365 and Office apps. For more information, see [Account privacy settings](#).

Office Roaming Service . The Office Roaming Service helps keep your settings, including your privacy settings, up to date on your devices running Microsoft 365 or Office apps. When you sign in to your apps with your Microsoft account or an account issued by your organization, the service synchronizes some of your personalized settings with Microsoft servers. When you sign in to another device with the same account, the Office Roaming Service downloads your settings from Microsoft servers and applies them to the additional device. When you sign out of your apps, the service removes your settings from your device. Any changes you make to your personalized settings are sent to Microsoft servers.

Diagnostic data . Diagnostic data is used to (i) keep your Microsoft 365 or Office applications secure and up to date; (ii) detect, diagnose, and fix problems; and (iii) make product improvements. This data does not include a user's name or email address, the contents of the user's files, or information about applications unrelated to Microsoft 365 or Office.

For more information, see the [Diagnostic Data](#) and [Diagnostic Data in Microsoft 365](#) sections .

Connected experiences . Microsoft 365 and Office offer more connected experiences to and supported by cloud-based services.

Using a document stored on OneDrive or translating the content of a Word document into another language are examples of connected experiences. There are two types of connected experiences.

- **Experiences that analyze your content** . Experiences that use your file content to provide design recommendations, editing suggestions, data insights, and similar features. Examples include PowerPoint Designer and Word Editor.
- **Experiences that download online content** . These are experiences that allow you to search for and download online content, including templates, images, 3D models, videos, and reference materials, to enhance your documents. Examples include PowerPoint templates and Getting Started Help.

If you choose to use connected experiences, we will collect the service data required to ensure that these connected experiences remain reliable, up-to-date, secure, and function as intended.

The privacy controls in your Microsoft 365 and Office client applications let you configure your connected experiences. However, even if you disable connected experiences, some features will still be available, such as mailbox syncing in Outlook, as well as the essential services described below. These controls are not available when using Microsoft 365 for the web because you are already connected to the cloud. For more information about accessing these controls, see [Account privacy settings](#).

Essential services . There are a number of services essential to how Microsoft 365 and Office work that cannot be disabled. For example, the licensing service, which verifies that you have the correct Microsoft 365 license, is essential. The required service data is collected and sent to Microsoft regardless of any other settings you have configured. See [Essential services](#) for more information.

Service data required for connected experiences . When you use a connected experience, the service data required to provide our cloud-based connected experiences is sent to and processed by Microsoft.

Required service data may include information related to the use of the connected experience necessary to ensure the security, updating, and proper functioning of the underlying service. If you choose to use a connected experience that analyzes your content—for example, Translate in Word—the text you typed and selected for translation is also sent and processed to provide you with that connected experience. Your text and the translation are not stored by our service. See [Required Service Data](#) for more information.

Using Device Features . Some Microsoft 365 apps use your device's features in various ways. In PowerPoint, for example, the presentation recording feature can access your device's microphone and camera to record presentations with audio and video. Your device's microphone is also accessible through the audio recording feature and when using Presenter Assistant. When creating a PowerPoint presentation, you can also use the Screen Capture and Screen Clipping features to capture screen content. Some Microsoft 365 apps, including PowerPoint, Word, and OneNote, offer Dictate, a connected experience that lets you use speech-to-text to write content using your microphone. In Word and OneNote, the Transcribe connected experience converts speech recorded directly in the app using your microphone or an audio recording into a text transcription, with each speaker's voice separated individually. OneNote can also insert photos or record videos using your camera. All Microsoft 365 apps, as well as To Do and Whiteboard, have sharing features that access your contacts to allow you to share documents with others in your contact list. The apps won't access your device's features until you start using it.

You can manage your microphone and camera access settings in the Windows Privacy Settings menu. Go to **Start > Settings > Privacy or Privacy & Security** . To learn more about how to control your privacy settings in apps, see [Windows privacy settings used by apps](#) .

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Microsoft Family Safety

The Microsoft Family Safety M365 product allows a family group to connect via the Microsoft Family Safety app on their Windows, Xbox, or mobile devices. Please carefully review the [Microsoft Family Safety](#) information if you choose to create or join a family group.

Microsoft Family Safety can help parents and guardians with tools such as digital content filtering, screen time limits, spending limits for the Microsoft and Xbox stores, age restrictions for apps and games, and location sharing. To learn more about how Microsoft collects and uses children's data, see the [Children's Data Collection section](#) of the Privacy Statement. If you use Microsoft Family Safety on Windows, see the [Windows Safety and Security Features section](#) of the Privacy Statement for more information.

To enable Family Safety controls on a child account, the child must be part of a family group. Accounts that require parental consent to be created are automatically added to the family group of the person who consented to the creation of the child account. For accounts that do not require parental consent, the parent or guardian must add the account to their family group to use Family Safety controls.

When you enable Family Activity Reporting for a child, Microsoft Corporation collects information about how the child uses their devices, such as searches, web activity, apps, and games, and provides parents with reports about the child's online activity. Activity reports are routinely deleted from Microsoft servers.

Some parental control features, such as Location Sharing, Ride Safety, Share Drives, Places, and Location Alerts, use your location information when turned on. When you turn on Location Sharing, for example, your device uploads location data to the cloud and shares it with other members of your family group. Microsoft only keeps your last known location for the Location Sharing feature. When you turn on Ride Safety, your location is used to record your driving habits, such as whether you use speed limits, use your phone while driving, and accelerate or decelerate suddenly. These reports will be uploaded to the cloud, and you can choose to share your drive reports with your family group. You can turn off these location features at any time in Parental Controls settings. You can manage your device's location data in the

Microsoft Privacy Dashboard. Learn more about [Family Safety and your location data](#) .

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Microsoft Launcher

Microsoft Launcher is an Android application that offers a highly customizable app launcher experience on Android devices.

Microsoft Launcher lets you sign in with your personal or work Microsoft account, or use it without one. However, some features may be limited if you don't grant certain permissions.

To use Microsoft Launcher, the application must be installed on your Android device and permissions are required to enable the following features:

Microsoft Copilot . When you're signed in with your personal Microsoft account, you can use Copilot features like chat, web search, voice search, and image search. Some Copilot features require access to your device's capabilities, such as the camera, microphone, photos, and videos. For more information, see our section on [AI and Copilot features](#) .

Glance.Quick Look helps you organize your daily activities, such as your Outlook calendar, to-do list, sticky notes, and recent documents, across your M365 apps. Once signed in with your personal or work Microsoft account, your data will sync across devices connected to the same account for a personalized experience. It also lets you view recent activity, such as recent photos and app usage, if you've granted Glance access to this data.

News Exchange (Chat) . When you sign in with your Microsoft account, you can enjoy personalized News Exchange (Chat) and ads in the Launcher news feed, synced across all your devices. You can also receive curated local news when you allow Microsoft Launcher to access your location information. You can manage your ad preferences through the [Microsoft Privacy Dashboard](#) .

All weather notifications . Microsoft Launcher lets you get the latest weather information on your home screen with MSN Weather. When you allow Launcher to access your location or provide your postal code, you can receive up-to-date local weather information.

Backup and restore . The Microsoft Launcher backup and restore feature lets you easily transfer your data from one phone to another or try out different home screen configurations. You can store backups locally on your device or save them to your OneDrive account linked to your Microsoft account for easy access.

Microsoft Launcher supports Android work profile features, allowing you to maintain a clear separation between personal and work data on your device. This means you can securely access work resources without mixing them with your personal apps and data.

To learn more about Microsoft Launcher and its supported features, please visit the page [here](#) .

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Microsoft Teams

This section applies to the consumer offering of Teams; if you are using Teams with a school or work account, see the [Enterprise and Developer products](#) in this privacy statement.

Teams is an all-in-one communication and collaboration hub. To provide Teams features, Microsoft collects usage data and information about your communications, including the time and date of the communication and the users involved. With your consent, you can share your location with family and friends.

Your Teams profile includes the information you provided when setting up a Microsoft account, such as your display name, email address, and/or phone number. Your Teams profile information may become visible to other users as a result of your interactions with them or your use of other apps or services, including Loop. Microsoft may also share this information with Enterprise customers when you interact through meetings and chats with end users who are using their school or work accounts. For example, if you participate in a Teams chat with a user who is using Teams linked to their school account, Microsoft may share your information with that user's school as part of providing the Teams service.

Search for Teams contacts . To allow others to find you on Teams (or on products that interact with Teams for personal use, including Teams for Business), your Teams profile is included in Teams' public search directories and may be displayed on Teams. Depending on your settings, Teams users can find you using your display name, email address, and/or phone number. Your profile includes your username, profile picture, and any other information you choose to add to your profile or display to others. Your Teams profile may be visible to Enterprise customers and their end users when you interact with an end user from an organization in chats and meetings.

Teams contact syncing . With your permission, Teams will periodically sync with your device and Outlook contacts and search for other Teams users who match contacts in your device's address book or Outlook. If you choose to stop syncing contacts from your device or Outlook, or if you are inactive on your device, any contacts that were not matched during the sync process will be removed from Teams. If you want to invite one of your device or Outlook contacts to a conversation, you can directly invite users in a one-on-one chat (1:1), or Microsoft can send an invitation on your behalf via SMS or email for group chat invitations.

Notice to non-user contacts: If your information appears in the device or Outlook address books of a Teams user who chooses to sync their device or Outlook contacts with their Teams contacts, Microsoft Corporation may process your data to determine if you are a current Teams user and to allow Teams users to invite you to the service, including via SMS and email. As long as the Teams user remains active in Teams on their device and continues to enable contact syncing with the relevant device or service, your information will be stored on our servers, and we will periodically process your information as part of the Teams user's contact syncing to check if you have recently joined Teams.

Learn more about [contact synchronization in Teams](#) .

If you choose to join Teams, you will appear as a new suggested Teams contact for all Teams users with your information in their device address books or Outlook.

Third-party contacts. You can also choose to sync contacts from third-party providers. You can choose to unsync your third-party contacts in Teams or

remove third-party contacts from all Microsoft apps and services. Please note that removing a third-party account from Teams may impact your experiences in other Microsoft Corporation apps and services that also use that account.

Teams Calendar. You can also choose to sync your Teams calendar with calendars from third-party providers. You can stop syncing your Teams calendar at any time by removing a third-party account from Teams. If you have consented to the use of third-party data on other Microsoft Corporation applications and services, please note that removing this third-party account data from Teams may impact your experiences on other Microsoft Corporation applications and services.

Push Notifications . Teams uses your device's notification service to notify you of incoming calls, conversations, and other messages. For many devices, these services are provided by a third-party company. To provide you with the caller ID or the first words of a new conversation, for example, Teams needs to inform the notification service so that it can send you the notification. The company providing the notification service on your device will use this information in accordance with its own terms of service and privacy policy. Microsoft is not responsible for the data collected by the notification service provider.

If you do not wish to use notification services for incoming Teams calls and messages, disable them in your device settings.

Discussions and meetings with end users of Enterprise customers . Many Microsoft products are intended for use by organizations, such as schools and businesses, as well as individual users. Please see the [Enterprise and Development Products section](#) of this Privacy Statement if you use Teams with a work or school account. If you participate in Teams meetings or discussions with end users from organizations, the data you share with those end users is subject to their organization's policies, if any. You should direct any privacy requests related to data shared through chats and meetings with end users from an organization, including any requests to exercise your data protection rights, to the organization's administrator. Microsoft is not responsible for the privacy or security policies or practices of its customers, which may differ from those stated in this Privacy Statement.

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Microsoft Translator

Microsoft Translator is a machine translation system and service designed to automatically translate between many supported languages. Microsoft Translator is available as a standalone consumer app for Android, iOS, and Windows, and its service features are also integrated into various Microsoft products and services, such as Translator Hub, Translator for Bing, and Translator for Microsoft Edge. Microsoft Translator processes the text, image, and voice data you send, as well as device and usage data, to provide translations, personalize your experience, and improve our products and services. Microsoft uses business and technical measures designed to help anonymize submitted data—for example, by removing identifiers and certain text such as email addresses and some number sequences that may contain personal information—when randomly sampling text and audio to improve the product. To learn more about how Microsoft handles your voice data, see [Speech Recognition Technologies](#).

Separate Microsoft translation services are available as features in other Microsoft products and services that have different privacy practices than Microsoft Translator. For more information about the Microsoft Azure Cognitive Services Translator Text API, Custom Translator, and Speech API, see the [Enterprise and Developer Products section of this Privacy Statement](#). To get the Translate feature in Microsoft 365 apps, see the [Productivity and Communication Products](#) section of this Privacy Statement.

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OneDrive

OneDrive lets you store and access your files on virtually any device, as well as share and collaborate on them with others. Some versions of the OneDrive app let you access both your personal OneDrive (by signing in with your personal Microsoft account) and your OneDrive for Business (by signing in with your work or school Microsoft account).

When you use OneDrive, we collect data about your use of the service and the content you store to provide, improve, and protect the services. For example, we index the content of your OneDrive documents so you can

search them later. We also collect device information so we can offer personalized experiences, such as allowing you to sync content across your devices.

When you store content in OneDrive, your content inherits the sharing permissions of the folder in which it is stored. For example, if you store content in a public folder, the content will be public and available to anyone who can find the folder.

When you share content from your OneDrive account to a social network like Facebook, your content is either uploaded directly to that social network or a link to it is posted on the service. This makes the content accessible to anyone on that social network. To remove the content, delete it from both the social network, if it was uploaded there, and OneDrive.

When you share your OneDrive content with others via a link, an email containing the link is sent to them, allowing anyone with the link to access your content. If someone who receives the link sends it to others, they will also be able to access your content, even if you didn't choose to share it with them. You can revoke access to your OneDrive content by signing in to your account and then selecting the relevant content to manage permission levels. Once permissions are revoked, the link is deactivated and can no longer be used unless you share it again.

Files managed in OneDrive for Business are stored separately from files stored in your personal OneDrive. OneDrive for Business collects and transmits personal data for authentication purposes, such as your email address and password, which will be shared with Microsoft and/or your Microsoft 365 service provider.

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Outlook

Outlook.com . Outlook.com is Microsoft's main consumer email service. It includes email accounts with addresses ending in outlook.com, live.com, hotmail.com, and msn.com. Outlook.com offers features that allow you to interact with your friends on social networks. You need to create a Microsoft account to use Outlook.com.

When you delete an email or item from your Outlook.com mailbox, it typically goes to your Deleted Items folder, where it remains for approximately 7 days unless you return it to your inbox, empty the folder, or the service automatically empties the folder, whichever occurs first. Once the Deleted Items folder is emptied, these items remain in our system for up to 30 days before permanent deletion, unless we are legally required to retain the data for a longer period.

Outlook applications . Outlook client applications are software that lets you manage email, calendar items, files, contacts, and other data from email, file storage, and other services, such as Exchange Online or Outlook.com, or even servers, like Microsoft Exchange. You can use Outlook applications, such as the Outlook app for Windows, with multiple accounts, including third-party provider accounts. To add an account to your Outlook applications, you must grant Outlook permission to access data from email or file storage services.

When you add an account to Outlook, your emails, calendar items, files, contacts, settings, and other data automatically sync to your device. On the Outlook mobile app, this data is also synced with Microsoft servers to enable enhanced features, such as improved search and personalized email filtering. On a computer, you can choose whether or not to sync your data with Microsoft servers. You can remove accounts or change sync settings at any time.

If you add a work or school account, your company may set rules and controls – such as requiring multi-factor authentication or remotely wiping data from your device – that may affect your use of Outlook.

Using device features . For Outlook clients that support it, you can use the Dictate feature to dictate content and send an email. You can dictate using your device's microphone or any other microphone you connect to your device. Outlook can also use your device's location information to provide you with weather information for your current location and allow you to search for nearby locations.

To learn more about the data collected and processed by Outlook applications, please see the [Microsoft 365](#) section of this privacy statement.

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Skype

The Skype dial pad lets you make and receive calls to landline or mobile numbers. This section applies to the consumer version of Skype; if you use Skype for Business, see the [Enterprise and Development Products](#) section of this privacy statement.

In order to provide these features, Microsoft collects usage data about your calls, including the time, date, and the numbers or usernames that are part of the calls.

Teams compatibility. As a Skype user, you can also sign in to Teams using your Skype account. If you sign in to Teams using your Skype credentials, you can use Teams to chat with and call other Teams users. For more information about Teams, see the [Microsoft Teams section](#) of this privacy statement.

Emergency calls from the Skype dial pad in the United States. If you enable location sharing for emergency calls, your location will be collected periodically to allow Microsoft Corporation to share your location with emergency call service providers if you dial 911. Your location information is shared only if you enable location sharing for emergency calls and place a 911 call.

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Surface

Microsoft offers its family of Surface devices and accessories to provide an exceptional computing experience, including browsing the web, watching and streaming videos, playing games, running applications like Excel, Word, and OneNote, and more. This includes devices and accessories such as Surface laptops, Surface Studios, Surface Book, Surface Pro, Surface Headphones, Surface Earbuds, Surface Dock, Surface Keyboard, and more.

Diagnostic data . Microsoft collects diagnostic data when you use your Surface devices, Surface accessories, and Surface apps. For more information, see the Diagnostic Data section of this Privacy Statement, [Diagnostic Data for Surface Products](#) , and [Diagnostic Data in the Surface App](#) . For a list of

diagnostic data required for Surface products, see [Diagnostic Data Required for Surface Products](#) .

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Surface Duo

Surface Duo supports cellular and Wi-Fi connectivity and can be used for email, internet browsing, gaming, and business connectivity services.

Microsoft provides a basic Surface Duo experience that runs on the Google Android operating system. The basic Surface Duo experience includes apps such as Microsoft Launcher, Setup Assistant, and My Phone Assistant. You can sign in with a Google ID and enable various Google services; you can also sign in with your Microsoft account and enable Microsoft services. Microsoft apps and services may use information provided by Google. Some features, such as location services, require Google to enable this feature and Microsoft to grant separate permission to use this information.

Diagnostic Data . Surface Duo collects diagnostic data to troubleshoot problems, keep the core Surface Duo experience up to date, maintain its security, and ensure its proper functioning. This data also allows us to improve Microsoft Surface Duo products and services, as well as related Microsoft products and services. The data does not include your username, email address, or the contents of your files. For more information, see the [Diagnostic Data](#) section of this Privacy Statement.

[Learn more about the Surface Duo's privacy settings](#) .

Surface Duo Location Settings . Surface Duo uses Google location services to determine your device's precise geographic location to provide enhanced experiences, such as displaying local weather. To allow Microsoft apps to access location-based features, you must enable location services for both Google and Microsoft. Some apps may require you to enable these settings separately in your Surface Duo settings. [Google's Privacy Policy](#) provides details about Google's location service and related data privacy practices. See [Surface Duo Location Settings](#) for more information.

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SwiftKey

The Microsoft SwiftKey keyboard and associated cloud services (collectively, "SwiftKey") process data about the words you use and how you type.

Microsoft uses this data to learn your writing style and provide personalized autocorrect and predictive text that adapts to you. We also use this data to offer a range of other features, such as predictive emoji input.

SwiftKey's predictive text technology learns your writing style and replicates it by analyzing the words and phrases you use most often across different apps and websites, creating a personalized language model to optimize text predictions. The keyboard avoids collecting sensitive information by excluding data from certain fields, such as passwords or payment information.

When you agree to share your data with us, SwiftKey collects device and usage data and uses de-identified device, usage, and template data to analyze service performance and improve products. You can also choose to share your SwiftKey language and input data to help improve Microsoft products and services. If you agree, SwiftKey may send brief snippets of anonymized data about what and how you type, along with associated correction data, to our servers for processing. These text snippets are used in automated processes to validate prediction services and improve product functionality. To protect your privacy, these snippets are never linked to your SwiftKey account. You can manage your choices at any time in your SwiftKey settings.

SwiftKey includes an optional OneDrive backup component. If you enable backup and sync, SwiftKey saves your language model and related data to OneDrive, allowing you to use personalized syncing of predictions, additional services, and settings across all your devices. You must sign in with a Microsoft account to enable OneDrive backup and sync. Data in OneDrive is protected by OneDrive security controls, including encryption in transit and at rest. You can disable backup at any time in SwiftKey's settings and manage or delete SwiftKey data in your OneDrive.

When you use the camera feature in SwiftKey, you can choose to apply augmented reality (AR) effects to your selfies via third-party lens services. The lens feature processes your videos and images to extract information about the location of your face and hands, solely for the purpose of transforming

your appearance with AR effects. This session data is processed only on your device, is not used to personally identify you, is deleted immediately after use, and is never sent to SwiftKey or any third party.

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LinkedIn

To learn more about the data collected by LinkedIn and how it is used and shared, please see LinkedIn's [privacy policy](#).

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Search and navigation

Search and navigation products make information available to you and intelligently capture, process, and act on that information, while learning and adapting over time. For more information about artificial intelligence and Copilot features in Microsoft search and navigation products, see [Artificial Intelligence and Microsoft Copilot Features](#) above.

[Learn more](#)

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Windows

Windows is a personalized computing environment that provides seamless access to services, preferences, and content across your computing devices. The core components of Windows are cloud-based, and both the cloud and on-premises elements of Windows are regularly updated, giving you the latest improvements and features. To provide this computing experience, we collect data about you, your device, and how you use Windows. Because Windows is personal to you, we offer you choices about the personal data we collect and how we use it. If your Windows device is managed by your organization, your organization may use centralized management tools provided by Microsoft or others to access and process your data, including your interaction data, diagnostic data, and the content of your communications and files, as well as to control device settings, including privacy settings, device policies, software updates, data collection by us or the organization, and other aspects of your device.

Windows Settings , formerly known as PC Settings, is a core component of Microsoft Windows and provides a convenient interface for adjusting user preferences, configuring the operating system, and managing connected devices. This allows you to manage user accounts, adjust network settings, and personalize various aspects of Windows. Windows Settings also lets you control which apps can access various device features, such as the camera, microphone, location, calendar, contacts, call history, messages, and more, while also controlling access to your personal data. Each feature has its own privacy settings page within Windows Settings, giving you control over which apps can use it.

The main features of the settings are as follows:

1. Personalization: Customize the appearance, language, and privacy settings of Windows, including using device features such as the microphone, camera, and location.
2. Device management: Install and manage devices such as printers, monitors, and external drives.
3. Network configuration: Adjust Wi-Fi, Ethernet, cellular, and VPN settings using the appropriate device identifiers.
4. Account management: Add or remove user accounts and manage login options.
5. System-level options: Configure display, notifications and power, then manage installed applications and more.
6. Privacy & Security Management: Set privacy preferences such as location and diagnostic data collection. Adjust which individual apps and services can access device features by enabling or disabling them.

For more information about data collection in Windows, see [Data Collection Summary for Windows](#) . This statement refers to Windows 10 and Windows 11, and references to Windows in this section relate to those product versions. Earlier versions of Windows are subject to their own privacy statements.

Activation

When you activate Windows, a specific product key is associated with the device on which your software is installed. The product key, along with data about your software and device, is sent to Microsoft to confirm the validity of your license for that software. This data may be sent again if you need to

reactivate or validate your license. On phones running Windows, device and network identifiers, as well as the device's location at the time of initial setup, are also sent to Microsoft for warranty registration, inventory replenishment, and fraud prevention purposes.

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Advertising ID

Windows generates an advertising ID for each user on a device, which Microsoft, third-party apps, and advertising networks can use to deliver relevant ads and personalized experiences in apps and across the web, similar to how websites use cookies. App developers and advertising networks may also use it for their own purposes, subject to their own privacy policies and the controls described below.

The advertising ID setting applies to Windows apps that use the Windows advertising identifier. You can disable the use of the advertising ID in the Windows Settings app. [Learn more about the advertising identifier in Windows](#) .

The advertising ID setting does not apply to other methods of personalized advertising offered by Microsoft or third parties, such as cookies used to display personalized display ads on websites. Third-party products accessed through or installed on Windows may also deliver other forms of personalized advertising subject to their own privacy policies. For more information about how Microsoft uses data for advertising purposes, see the "[How We Use Personal Data](#)" and "[Advertising](#)" sections of this Privacy Statement.

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Activating the mobile plan from the mobile operator's website

When you activate a cellular data plan with a third-party mobile operator for your Windows device via the Settings app in Windows, the operator's website may request access to your device and SIM card identifiers. With your consent, the Settings app may share these specific identifiers with the operator's website.

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Diagnostics

As mentioned in the [Diagnostic Data](#) section above, Microsoft collects diagnostic data to troubleshoot and keep its products, such as Windows, up-to-date, secure, and operational, as well as to improve Windows and related Microsoft products and services. This data is routinely collected from your device and stored with unique identifiers to help Microsoft recognize individual users on a device and identify problems and usage patterns.

Some information in the product documentation and other materials refers to required diagnostic data as "basic diagnostic data" and optional diagnostic data as "full diagnostic data." See the [Data Collection Summary for Windows](#) for more information about how Windows uses diagnostic data. For an up-to-date list of **required** and **optional diagnostic** data collected, see [Required Windows Diagnostic Events and Fields \(Basic Level\)](#) or [Optional Windows Diagnostic Data \(Full Level\)](#).

If you use a work or school account, your organization may enroll your device in the Windows Diagnostic Data Processor configuration. Microsoft processes Windows diagnostic data based on an agreement with the organization. If an organization uses Microsoft management tools or engages Microsoft to manage your device, both Microsoft and your organization may process and use your device's diagnostic and error data for device management, monitoring, troubleshooting, and other organizational purposes.

The required diagnostic data includes information about your device, its settings and capabilities, and its proper functioning. We collect the following required diagnostic data:

- Device, connectivity and configuration data:
 - Device data such as processor type, OEM manufacturer, battery type and capacity, number and type of cameras, firmware, and memory attributes.
 - Network features and connection data, such as the device's IP address, mobile network, and whether the device is connected to a free or paid network.

- Operating system data and configuration, such as operating system version and build number, region and language settings, diagnostic data settings, and whether the device is part of the Windows Insider program.
- Data about connected devices such as model, manufacturer, drivers and compatibility data.
- Data about applications installed on the device, such as the name, version, and publisher of the application.
- Whether a device is ready to receive an update and can receive it depends on factors such as low battery, limited disk space, or connectivity via a paid network.
- Indicates whether the updates were successfully installed or not.
- Data relating to the reliability of the diagnostic collection system.
- Basic error reports consisting of integrity check data concerning the operating system and applications running on your device.

Optional diagnostic data includes more detailed information about your device, its settings, capabilities, and health status. When you choose to send optional diagnostic data, the required diagnostic data will still be included, and we collect the following additional information:

- Additional data about the device, connectivity and configuration, in addition to that collected as part of the data required for diagnosis.
- Status and logging information relating to the integrity of the operating system and other system components in addition to that collected concerning update and diagnostic systems as mandatory diagnostic data.
- Application activity, for example the programs that are run on a device, the duration of their execution, and the speed at which programs respond to inputs.
- Browser activity, including browsing history and search terms in Microsoft Edge.
- Improved error reporting, including device memory status during a system or application crash (the report may unintentionally contain user content, such as parts of a file you were using when the problem occurred).

Even if you choose to send us optional diagnostic data, some of the data described above may not be collected from your device. Microsoft limits the amount of data it collects by taking certain data only from a subset of devices (a sample). The Diagnostic Data Viewer tool shows whether your device is part of a sample and what specific data is collected from your device. You can

find download instructions for the Diagnostic Data Viewer tool in the Windows Settings app under **Diagnostics & feedback** .

The specific data collected by Windows Diagnostics may change as needed to address new issues or support newly released devices. For example, Microsoft may collect new types of data to troubleshoot performance problems or update devices. We provide partners, such as device manufacturers, with limited portions of error report information only to help them repair or improve their products and services that work with Windows and other Microsoft products and services. We may also share certain aggregated and de-identified diagnostic data, such as general trends in the use of Windows apps and features, with selected third parties. [Learn more about diagnostic data in Windows](#) .

Handwriting and typing recognition . You can choose to help Microsoft improve handwriting and typing recognition by submitting handwriting and typing diagnostic data. If this option is enabled, Microsoft collects examples of what you type or write to improve features such as handwriting recognition, autocomplete, next-word prediction, and spell checking in multiple languages. The collected data is divided into small samples and processed to remove information that could identify you or allow the original content to be reconstructed, such as unique identifiers, sequencing details, email addresses, and numeric values. Performance data, including text edits you make manually and words you add to the dictionary, is also included. [Learn more about improving inking and typing in Windows](#) .

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Personalized offers

If you choose to enable **Personalized Offers** , we'll use information about your device and how you use it, including Windows diagnostic data, in combination with your account information and data collected by other Microsoft products and services to provide you with personalized tips, ads, and recommendations to improve your Windows experiences. Personalized offers include suggestions on how to customize and optimize Windows, as well as ads and recommendations for Microsoft and third-party products, services, features, apps, and hardware to enhance your Windows experiences.

For example, Windows might tell you about new features to help you get the most out of your device. If you stream movies in your browser, Windows might recommend an app from the Microsoft Store that streams more efficiently. Or, if you're running out of hard drive space, Windows might recommend trying OneDrive or buying hardware to add more storage.

When personalized offers are enabled, Windows may use your required diagnostic data to personalize offers. This data may include information about your device, its settings and capabilities, and its overall health. If you have chosen to share optional diagnostic data, the data used to personalize offers may also include information about how you use apps and features, as well as additional information about your device's health. We may also use information about your device and your activity to personalize offers locally on your device, even when the data does not leave your device. We do not use the contents of crash dumps, voice input, typing, or inking data to personalize offers.

In addition to information about your device and how you use it, including Windows diagnostic data, we may use or combine the following data from other Microsoft products and your account with Windows diagnostic data to personalize offers:

- Web activity, if you allow Microsoft Edge to collect your web activity for personalized searches, ads, and news.
- Information about your use of other Microsoft products and services, including Microsoft Bing, Microsoft 365, Xbox, and Microsoft websites, such as MSN.com.
- Subscription and purchase history.
- Data from third-party websites that may be shared with Microsoft.

We may also use information about your interactions with tips, recommendations, and promotions to provide and improve personalized offers and similar messages in other Microsoft products.

To manage how data collected by other Microsoft products is used to personalize offers, you can visit your [Personalized ads and offers page](#). In some regions, such as the European Economic Area, turning off personalized offers on Windows also stops the use of data from other Microsoft products to personalize tips, ads, and recommendations in Windows. In other regions,

you can manage how data collected by other Microsoft products is used to personalize offers by visiting your [Personalized ads and offers page](#) .

Contextual data from your device and certain basic account data are used to show you relevant messages in Windows, regardless of whether the Personalized offers setting in Windows or settings that allow the use of data from other Microsoft products to personalize offers are disabled. For example, this data is used to ensure that content is in the correct language and appropriate for your age group.

Personalized offers apply to the tips, deals, ads, and recommendations you see in Windows. Changing this setting won't affect the types of offers you see in other Microsoft products. You can change this setting at any time by searching for **Personalized offers** in the Windows Settings app. [Learn more about personalized offers](#) .

Personalization of the user experience

Personalized experiences are being replaced by personalized offers in newer versions of Windows. If you haven't installed the latest Windows Update, you may still see personalized experiences on your device.

If you choose to enable personalized experiences, we will use your Windows diagnostic data (required or optional, depending on your choice) to provide you with personalized tips, ads, and recommendations to improve your Microsoft experience. If you selected the Required level for diagnostic data, personalization is based on information about your device, its settings and capabilities, and its proper functioning. If you selected the Optional level, personalization is also based on your use of apps and features, as well as additional information about your device's health. However, we do not use information about the websites you visit, crash dump content, voice, typing, or handwriting data for personalization when we receive this data from customers who selected the Optional level. Data related to personalized experiences is transmitted to Microsoft and stored with one or more unique identifiers that can help us recognize an individual user on an individual device and understand service issues and device usage patterns.

A personalized user experience includes suggestions for customizing and optimizing Windows, as well as ads and recommendations for Microsoft and third-party products, services, features, apps, and hardware to improve your Windows experience. For example, to help you get the most out of your

device, we may suggest new features or features you may not know about. If you encounter a problem with your Windows device, we may suggest a solution. You might be able to personalize your lock screen with photos, or display more photos you like or fewer photos you don't. If you watch movies in your browser, we may suggest a better-performing app from the Microsoft Store. Similarly, if you're running out of hard drive space, Windows may recommend trying OneDrive or purchasing hardware for additional storage.

[Learn more about personalized experiences in Windows](#) .

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Feedback Hub

The Feedback Hub lets you provide feedback on Microsoft products, installed internal apps, and, in some cases, third-party apps. It determines which apps are installed on your device using public APIs. For HoloLens users, the Feedback Hub can access your camera and microphone when you choose to share audio or your environment, and use your image and document libraries to attach screenshots and screen recordings to your feedback submissions.

You can sign in to the Feedback Hub using your personal Microsoft account or a work or school account. When you use a work or school account, your feedback may be associated with your organization and visible to its administrators through the Feedback Hub or the admin center. Regardless of the account you use, your feedback may be publicly accessible depending on your organization's settings.

When you send Microsoft feedback about a problem, diagnostic data is sent to help improve Microsoft products and services. The Feedback Hub sends this data automatically or gives you the option to send it, depending on your diagnostic data settings in the **Diagnostics & feedback** section of Windows settings. Additional personal data may be collected depending on the type of feedback you provide to better address specific issues—for example, location data when you provide feedback on location services. Microsoft may also share your feedback and related data with partners, such as device manufacturers or firmware developers, to help resolve issues with products and services that work with Windows. [Learn more about diagnostic data in Windows](#) .

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Microsoft Help

Microsoft Help allows Windows users to get technical support for Windows and other Microsoft software. It provides self-service assistance, such as links to help articles or guidance on how to troubleshoot problems yourself, recommends diagnostics, and helps connect you with a live Microsoft agent if needed. If you choose to run a diagnostic, all collected diagnostic data is managed according to the **Windows Diagnostics section** above. You can sign in with your Microsoft account to create a support case, and organizational account users can also do so, depending on their organization's support agreement and administrator settings.

If your system settings allow it, you can use the system microphone in Help to ask your support question verbally instead of typing it, using the controls available in the "Microphone privacy settings" of the Windows Settings app. Microsoft Help does not use your location for its services.

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Live subtitles

Live captions transcribe audio to make spoken content easier to understand. Live captions can generate captions from any audio content containing speech, whether the audio is online, downloaded to your device, or received from your microphone. By default, microphone audio transcription is disabled.

Captioned speech data is processed solely on your device and is not shared in the cloud or with Microsoft. [Learn more about live captions](#) .

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Location services

Windows Location Service . Microsoft's location service helps determine the precise geographic location of your Windows device using a combination of GPS, nearby wireless access points and routers, cell towers, an IP address, or the default location.

Location services let you control which apps are allowed to access your precise location. When location services are turned off, Windows and apps can't access your device's location, and some apps might not be able to access Wi-Fi network information. When location services are turned on, apps can access an approximate location and request permission to use a precise one. You can manage these permissions in Windows settings. When location services are enabled, data about cell towers, Wi-Fi access points, and their locations is collected, de-identified, and used to improve location services.

[Learn more about location services in Windows](#) .

If an app or feature accesses your device's location and you're signed in with your Microsoft account, your most recent known location information is also saved in the cloud. This information is available on your devices to other apps or services that use your Microsoft account and to which you've granted permission. You can view or delete this location information from the Privacy Dashboard in your Microsoft account.

The method for determining your device's location is managed directly through location settings, with a few exceptions. For example, desktop applications are a type of application that doesn't support on-the-job control over access to precise location. Desktop applications are typically downloaded from the internet or installed from physical media, such as a CD, DVD, or USB storage device.

Even when you have disabled location services in Windows, some third-party applications and services may use other technologies (Bluetooth, IP address, cellular modem, etc.) or cloud location services to determine the location of your device with varying degrees of accuracy.

To make it easier for you to get help in an emergency, every time you make an emergency call, Windows attempts to determine and share your exact location, regardless of your location settings. Additionally, your mobile carrier will have access to your device's location if it uses a cellular service.

General location . If you enable location services in Windows Settings, apps that can't use your precise location can still access your general or approximate location, such as your city, postal code, or region.

A limited set of features in Windows uses your IP address to provide contextual information about your region if location services are disabled, such as the weather in the taskbar. For more information about specific Windows apps that use device location, see the [Windows Apps](#) section of this privacy statement.

Find My Device . The Find My Device feature lets a Windows device administrator locate the device's location from account.microsoft.com/devices. To enable Find My Device, an administrator must be signed in with a Microsoft account, and location services must be enabled. This feature will work even if other users have denied location access for all their apps. When the administrator tries to locate the device, users see a notification in the notification area. [Learn more about Find My Device in Windows](#) .

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Narrator

Narrator is a screen reader built into Windows that lets you navigate your device without a screen. When you use features such as image descriptions or page title descriptions (by pressing Narrator + Ctrl + D), or lists of popular links (Narrator + double-tap S), the image or URL of the web page you are viewing is sent to Microsoft. This data is used only to generate the requested descriptions or summaries and to improve Microsoft services, such as Bing. Images are not retained by Microsoft after analysis.

You can disable these features at any time by going to **Narrator > Get picture descriptions, page titles, and popular links** in Windows settings.

You can also send feedback about Narrator to help Microsoft diagnose and fix Narrator issues and improve Microsoft products and services, such as Windows. Voice feedback can be sent at any time in Narrator using the Narrator + Alt + F key combination. The Feedback Hub app opens when you use this command and gives you the option to send voice feedback. If you

enable the "Help improve Narrator" setting in the Windows Settings app and send voice feedback through Feedback Hub, recent device and usage data, including Event Tracking Log (ETL) data, will be sent along with your voice feedback to help improve Microsoft products and services, such as Windows.

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Mobile experiences related to Windows

The Mobile Connected feature allows you to link your mobile phone to your Windows PC, enabling different cross-device experiences across all your Windows devices.

Some features of Mobile Connected, as well as the resulting data that is synchronized between your phone and Windows devices, differ for Android devices and iPhones and are described separately below.

In order to provide Mobile Connected features, Microsoft Corporation collects performance, usage and device data, including, for example, the hardware capabilities of your mobile phone and Windows device, the number and duration of your sessions on Your Phone and the time you spent on setup.

Android devices

You can use Connected Mobile to view recent photos, view and send text messages, and make and receive live calls from your Android phone on your Windows device. You can also view, dismiss, or perform other actions on notifications from your Android phone, instantly access and use Android apps installed on your Android phone from your Windows device, and share your phone's screen on your Windows device via Connected Mobile's screen mirroring feature.

To use Connected Mobile, you must install the Link to Windows app on your Android device and grant the requested app permissions. You must sign in to your Microsoft account on the Connected Mobile feature of your Windows device and on Link to Windows on your Android phone. Both devices must be connected to the internet. Some features require Bluetooth and pairing your phone with your PC.

We never store your SMS messages, call history, photos, applications you have, or information displayed by applications on our servers, and we never modify them on your phone.

You can unlink your Android phone from your Windows device at any time by going to the Connected Mobile settings and choosing to remove your Android phone, or from the Link to Windows settings on your Android phone. For detailed information, see [our support page](#).

Text Messages. The Connected Mobile feature lets you view SMS messages you've received on your Android phone on your Windows device and send SMS messages from your Windows device. Connected Mobile accesses the content of your SMS messages and the contact information of the sender or recipient. These SMS messages are stored temporarily on your device, and only messages received and sent within the last 30 days are visible on your Windows device.

Calls. Connected Mobile lets you make, receive, and view recent calls from your Android phone on your Windows device. To enable this feature, you need to grant certain permissions both on the Connected Mobile settings page on your Windows device and in your Android phone's settings, such as access to the call log and permission to make calls from your PC. These call details are temporarily stored on your Windows device, and only calls received and made within the last 30 days are visible in the call logs on your Windows device.

Photos. Connected Mobile lets you copy, share, edit, save, or delete a limited number of your most recent photos from your Android phone to your Windows device. These photos are temporarily stored on your Windows device.

Notifications. Mobile Connected lets you view, read, dismiss, or perform other actions related to notifications from your Android phone on your Windows device. To enable this Mobile Connected feature, you need to grant certain permissions, such as syncing notifications, on both your Windows device and your Android phone.

App mirroring. On supported devices, Mobile Connected lets you use Android apps installed on your Android phone on your Windows device. Microsoft collects a list of your installed Android apps and recent activity to

provide the service and show you your most recently used apps, but does not retain any other information.

Instant Hotspot. On supported Android devices, Link to Windows allows users to share mobile hotspot information with their paired PC via secure Bluetooth communication. Your PC can then be connected to the internet. Note that mobile data charges may apply depending on your mobile data plan.

Contacts. Link to Windows lets you sync your Android contacts to the Microsoft cloud. You can access them in other Microsoft products and services by going to Link to Windows settings and enabling the "Sync contacts" feature. Your contact information is stored online and associated with your Microsoft account. [Learn more](#) .

iPhones

You can use Mobile Connected to make and receive calls from your iPhone, view and send text messages, and view, dismiss, or perform other actions on your iPhone notification from your Windows device.

To use Connected Mobile, you must have Bluetooth enabled on your iPhone. You can also install the Link with Windows app on your iPhone.

You can unpair your iPhone from your Windows device at any time by going to the Connected Mobile settings and choosing to remove your iPhone. You can do the same from your iPhone by going to **Settings > Bluetooth > Select your PC's name > tap the (i) icon > and choose** Forget This Device.

We never store your SMS messages or call history on our servers, and we never modify them on your iPhone.

Text messages. Mobile Connected lets you view text messages sent from your iPhone on your Windows devices and send text messages from your Windows device. Mobile Connected accesses the content of your text messages and the contact information of the sender or recipient. These text messages are stored temporarily on your Windows device, and only text messages received and sent during your Bluetooth or iMessage session are visible on your Windows devices.

Calls. Mobile Connect lets you make, receive, and view recent calls from your iPhone on your Windows device. To enable this feature, you must turn on

Sync Contacts in Bluetooth settings on your iPhone. Details of these calls are temporarily stored on your Windows device.

Mobile-connected notifications let you view, read, dismiss, or perform other actions related to notifications from your iPhone on your Windows device. To enable this Mobile-connected feature, you need to grant certain permissions, such as syncing notifications, on both your Windows device and your iPhone.

Contacts. Connected Mobile allows you to sync your contacts from your iPhone so you can access them for messaging and calls by going to your iPhone's Bluetooth settings and enabling Sync Contacts under your PC's name after connecting your iPhone to Connected Mobile.

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Inter-device experiments

Cross-device experiences in Windows allow you to access a linked mobile device from your PC using your Microsoft account. By linking your mobile device and enabling these experiences, Windows can make certain content from the mobile device available within Windows to provide features and services that support built-in cross-device functionality. These can be managed under "Mobile devices" in the Bluetooth & Devices section of your Windows PC settings. In providing these features, Microsoft collects performance and device usage data, including information about the hardware capabilities of your mobile and Windows devices. You can turn this feature on or off at any time in your Windows PC settings.

Use your mobile device as a connected camera. This feature lets you use your mobile device's camera in apps or products on Windows that support camera functionality. You can enable this feature under "Mobile devices" in the Bluetooth & Devices section of your PC's Settings. Microsoft does not record or store your camera sessions or information displayed by your camera in any app or product.

Receive new photo notifications from your mobile device. This feature lets you receive notifications from your linked mobile device on your Windows PC. These photos are temporarily stored on your Windows PC when

you edit or open them. You must initiate the save process on your PC to store these photos until you decide to delete them. We never store your photos on our servers and we do not edit or delete any photos on your mobile device.

Display your mobile device in File Explorer and the device name in

Windows Share. This feature lets you access your mobile device's files in File Explorer. You can enable this feature under "Mobile devices" in the Bluetooth & Devices section of your PC's Settings. Microsoft will not store the contents of your files on its services.

You can also enable access to your linked mobile device via Windows Share. You can turn this on in Settings > Bluetooth & Devices > Mobile devices. Once enabled, your linked devices will be visible in Windows, allowing you to share files and folders between your PC and your mobile device.

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Registration

Some Windows devices have a recording feature that lets you store audio and video clips of your activity on that device, including communications with others. If you choose to record a session, the recording will be saved locally on your device. In some cases, you may have the option to share the recording with a Microsoft product or service that will then broadcast the recording publicly. **Important: You should understand your legal responsibilities before recording and/or sharing any communication. This may include obtaining prior consent from everyone involved in the conversation or any other required permissions.** Microsoft is not responsible for how you use the recording features or for your recordings.

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Security features

Device encryption . Device encryption helps protect the data stored on your device by encrypting it using BitLocker Drive Encryption technology. When device encryption is enabled, Windows encrypts the drive on which Windows is installed and generates a recovery key. Your personal device's BitLocker

recovery key is automatically backed up online and associated with your personal Microsoft account. Microsoft does not use your individual recovery keys for any purpose.

Malware Removal Tool (MSRT). MSRT runs on your device at least once a month as part of Windows Update. It checks for infections caused by specific and widespread malware and helps remove detected infections. When MSRT runs, it removes malware detected on your device, which is listed on the Microsoft Support website. During a malware scan, a report will be sent to Microsoft with specific data about the malware detected, any errors, and other data related to your device. You can disable MSRT's reporting feature if you do not want to send this data to Microsoft.

Microsoft Family . Parents can use Parental Controls to understand and set limits on their child's device use. Please carefully review the [Microsoft Family Safety](#) information if you choose to create or join a family group. For users under the age of 13, or as required by law in their jurisdiction, certain Microsoft products and services will block users under 13 or require parental or guardian consent or permission before they can use them, including when creating an account to access Microsoft services. If you are under the legal age in your region, during the signup process, you will be asked to request parental or guardian consent by entering an adult's email address. When Family Activity Reporting is enabled for a child, Microsoft collects information about how that child uses the device and provides parents with reports on their child's activity. Activity reports are routinely deleted from Microsoft servers.

Microsoft Defender SmartScreen and Smart App Control . Microsoft strives to protect your device and passwords from insecure apps, files, and web content.

Microsoft Defender SmartScreen helps protect you and your device by identifying threats from unsafe websites, apps, and files. When checking content, it sends relevant data, including web addresses and, if necessary, details about suspicious sites or apps, to Microsoft for security analysis. This data will only be used for security purposes to detect, protect against, and respond to security incidents, identity theft, fraud, or other malicious, deceptive, or illegal activity. If a threat is detected, you will receive a warning instead of the content. You can turn this feature on or off in the Windows Security app.

When supported, Smart App Control checks the software installed on your device for potential threats. On supported devices, it starts in evaluation mode using data collected by Microsoft Defender SmartScreen, such as filenames, hashes, download locations, and digital certificates, to determine if Smart App Control is right for your device. If your device is eligible, Smart App Control is automatically enabled for added protection; otherwise, it remains permanently disabled. For unsupported or unsuitable devices, Microsoft Defender SmartScreen continues to provide protection. When Smart App Control is active, it blocks apps identified as malicious, potentially unwanted, or unknown and unsigned, and alerts you before they open, run, or install. [Learn more about Smart App Control](#) .

When Microsoft Defender SmartScreen or Smart App Control scans a file, data about that file is sent to Microsoft, including the file name, a hash of the file's contents, the download location, and the file's digital certificates. You can turn Smart App Control on or off in the Windows Security app.

Microsoft Defender Antivirus . Microsoft Defender Antivirus automatically activates to protect your device when no other antimalware software is running. It monitors your device's security status and scans for malware, unwanted software, and potentially dangerous applications. When Microsoft Defender Antivirus is enabled or running, it automatically sends reports to Microsoft containing data about suspicious malware and other unwanted software, potentially unwanted applications, and other malicious content. It may also send files for review that might contain malicious content, such as malware or unknown files. If a report is likely to contain personal data, you will be asked for permission before it is sent. You can choose to disable reporting and file sharing with Microsoft.

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Voice, voice activation, handwriting input and typing

Speech . Microsoft provides both device-based speech recognition functionality and cloud-based (online) speech recognition technologies.

Enabling the online speech recognition setting allows applications to use Microsoft speech recognition in the cloud. Additionally, in Windows 10, online speech recognition enables you to use dictation within Windows.

Voice activation during HoloLens setup or Windows Mixed Reality installation allows you to use your voice for commands, dictation, and application interactions. Both device-based and online speech recognition settings will be enabled. Once both settings are enabled and your headset is powered on, the device continuously listens for your voice input and sends your voice data to Microsoft's cloud-based speech recognition technologies.

When you use our cloud-based speech recognition technologies, we collect and use your voice recordings to create a text transcript of the words in the voice data. Microsoft does not store, sample, or listen to your voice recordings without your permission. [Learn more about Microsoft and your voice data](#) .

You can turn off online speech recognition at any time and prevent apps that rely on this setting from sending your voice data to Microsoft. You can still use device-based speech recognition services that don't rely on the cloud and use only on-device recognition, such as Captions, Narrator, or Voice Access, without sending your voice data to Microsoft. However, Microsoft's cloud-based speech recognition technologies provide more accurate recognition than device-based ones.

If you're using a HoloLens or Windows Mixed Reality headset, you can also disable device-based speech recognition at any time. This prevents the device from listening to your voice input. [Learn more about speech recognition in Windows](#) .

Voice activation . Windows provides supported applications with the ability to respond and act based on application-specific voice keywords.

If you've allowed an app to listen for voice keywords, Windows will actively monitor the microphone for those keywords. Each app must ask for your permission before accessing your microphone. When a keyword is detected, the app will access your voice recording and process it, perform an action, and respond, such as speaking a reply. The app may send your voice recording to its own cloud services to process commands and collect recordings for other purposes, such as improving its services.

Voice activation can be enabled when the device is locked and the screen is off. Once an app is activated using a voice keyword, it can continue listening to the microphone. The app can be activated by anyone speaking near the

device and access the same set of features and information as when the device is unlocked.

You can disable voice activation at any time. [Learn more about voice activation in Windows](#) .

Even when you've disabled voice activation, some third-party services and desktop applications may still be listening to the microphone and collecting your voice input. [Learn more about third-party desktop applications and how they can still access your microphone even when these settings are disabled](#) .

Voice typing . In Windows 11, dictation is now called voice typing. Voice typing can use speech recognition technologies both on devices and online to power its speech-to-text transcription service. You can also choose to contribute to voice snippets to improve voice typing. If you choose not to contribute to voice snippets, you can still use voice typing. You can change your selection at any time in the voice typing settings. Microsoft does not store, sample, or listen to your voice recordings without your permission. [Learn more about Microsoft and your voice data](#) .

Voice Access . Windows lets everyone, including people with disabilities, control their PC and create text using their voice. For example, Voice Access supports scenarios such as opening and switching between applications, browsing the web, and reading and creating messages. Voice Access leverages modern speech recognition on the device to accurately recognize voice and is supported without an internet connection. When a user invokes Voice Access, it uses the device's microphone. [Learn more about Voice Access](#) .

Inking & Input Personalization . Your typed and handwritten words are collected to provide you with a personalized word list, improved character recognition to help you type and write on your device, and text suggestions that appear as you type or write.

You can turn off handwriting and input customization at any time. This will delete your custom word list stored on your device. If you turn it back on, you'll need to recreate your custom word list. [Learn more about handwriting customization in Windows](#) .

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Sync and backup settings

When you sign in to Windows with your Microsoft account, Windows may store your device settings, files, and configuration data on Microsoft servers. Windows will only use the stored device settings, files, and configuration data to facilitate your migration experience to another device.

You can disable this feature and prevent Windows from storing your settings, files, and configuration data in Windows Settings. You can delete data that was previously saved to your Microsoft account by visiting the [Devices page of your Microsoft account](#) .

[Learn more about Windows backup and sync settings](#) .

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Update services

Update services for Windows include Windows Update and Microsoft Update. Windows Update is a service that provides software updates for Windows software and other support software, such as drivers and firmware provided by device manufacturers. Microsoft Update is a service that provides updates for other Microsoft software, such as Microsoft 365.

Windows Update automatically downloads Windows software updates to your device. You can configure Windows Update to automatically install these updates as soon as they are available (recommended) or have Windows notify you when a restart is required to complete the update installation. Apps available through the Microsoft Store are automatically updated through the Microsoft Store, as described in the [Microsoft Store](#) section of this privacy statement.

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Windows AI Features

Click actions

Click Actions can function as a standalone feature or in conjunction with Finder. Once launched, Click Actions lets you capture and analyze screenshots, identify the presence of text and images, and suggest relevant actions for each, such as editing a screenshot or reviewing captured text. Click Actions cannot identify the content of screenshots, but you can use local AI or other tools to edit that content if you wish. All activities remain on your local device unless you explicitly choose to share them, such as by submitting an image for a Bing search, requesting a summary of selected text (processed by Microsoft's Azure AI cloud service), or using another tool to edit a screenshot.

In addition, Click Actions lets you use your microphone to search for text in a screenshot: when you click the microphone button, it listens to what is said, enters it into the search box, and highlights all matching results. The audio captured by the microphone is not transmitted outside your device.

Windows Find

Finder is a Windows feature available exclusively on Copilot+ PCs that helps users retrieve previously viewed content using memorized text or visual cues. To use Finder, users must choose to save snapshots—screen images with metadata such as the application name and timestamp—which are stored securely locally and protected by Windows Hello Enhanced Security (ESS). Each time Finder is opened, users must authenticate using Windows Hello biometric login or a PIN to decrypt the snapshot content. Snapshot analysis and processing occur only on the device. Click Actions runs on top of the snapshots in Finder to help you interact with your on-screen images or text.

Finder lets you search for text in snapshots captured using your Copilot+ PC's microphone. When you click the microphone button in the Finder window's search box, it captures what you said in the search area. The microphone remains active until you pause speaking, and all captured audio content stays on your device.

Retrouver securely stores all captured data—including personal data such as snapshots, metadata, processing results, and user queries—locally on your Copilot+ PC and within your connected account. This information is never transmitted off your device unless you perform an action, such as capturing a snapshot in another application or typing comments via the Windows

Feedback Hub with an attached snapshot. The only way to share content from Retrouver is through explicit user action on the device.

You can control your content (such as snapshots, metadata, search queries, and history) by pausing or deleting snapshots, filtering content, or using a supported browser in incognito mode. [Learn more about protecting your privacy and controlling your experience with Finder](#) .

In addition to its search functionality, Finder also includes a timeline feature that organizes snapshots chronologically in a timeline displayed via a horizontal scroll bar, making it easier to view and use your past PC activities. Within the timeline view, you can delete snapshots individually, by website domain, or by application.

Retrouver also features a sensitive content filter, enabled by default, which prevents the storage of more sensitive information (credit card numbers, government-issued identification numbers, etc.). Users can disable this filter in their Windows settings if they wish.

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Windows Applications

A number of Microsoft apps are included with Windows, and others are available in the Microsoft Store. Visit [the Microsoft Store](#) to learn more about each of these apps, including:

Camera app . If you allow the Camera app to use your location, the system embeds location data in photos and videos you take with your device. Photos and videos also include other descriptive data, such as the camera model and the date the photo or video was taken. If you choose to share a photo or video, any embedded data will be accessible to the people and services you share it with. You can always disable the Camera app's access to your location by turning off all location services in your device's Settings menu or by disabling the Camera app's access to location services.

When the Camera app is open, it displays rectangles detected by the selected camera for areas of the image that may be used for image enhancement. The Camera app does not store any image enhancement data. You can always change your camera access settings in the Windows Settings menu. The

Camera app uses various device features, such as location, camera, microphone, video, and image library.

Photos app . Two versions of the Photos app are available. The updated Photos app includes features such as iCloud integration and local and cloud folder views. The previous legacy version of the Photos app includes features such as the Video Editor, the Contacts tab, and Albums. You are using the updated Photos app if the "About" section in the Photos app settings indicates that the app is the "Updated" version of the Photos app.

The updated Photos app lets you organize, view, and share photos and videos by grouping them according to options such as name, date taken or modified, and storage location—whether local or synced from cloud services like OneDrive and iCloud. You can move, copy, or upload files to your computer or OneDrive, and quickly access all your photos by date, favorites, folders, and cloud service tabs for easy browsing and management.

The legacy Photos app lets you organize, view, and share your photos and videos, offering features not available in the updated Photos app, such as Collections, Albums, the Video Editor, and the Contacts setting. Collections display photos and videos by date taken. Albums allow you to organize by location and tags, and the Video Editor provides tools for editing, creating, and sharing videos.

The Contacts setting in the legacy Photos app, when enabled, uses face grouping technology to organize your local photos and videos by detecting faces and grouping visually similar ones. You can then associate these face groupings with contacts in your People app. You can enable this feature from the Settings page or the People tab.

When People settings are enabled in the legacy Photos app, your face groupings are stored on your device as long as you keep the groupings or the associated photos or videos themselves. If you haven't used the legacy Photos app for three years, you'll be prompted to allow face grouping to continue. You can turn People settings on or off at any time in Settings; when you turn it off, face grouping data is removed from the app, but your photos or videos are not. [Learn more about the Photos app and face grouping](#) .

If you choose to share a photo or video using the Photos app or the legacy photos app, all embedded data (such as location, camera model, and date) is

accessible to the people and services with whom you share the photo or video.

The People app centralizes your contacts in one place by automatically importing them when you add accounts, including email and social media accounts. When you add an account, we inform you of the data the People app can import or sync with the specific service and let you choose what to add. Other apps you install can also sync data with the People app, including adding information to existing contacts. When viewing a contact, recent interactions such as emails and calendar events from synced apps are displayed. You can remove an account from the People app at any time.

Outlook Mail and Calendar app . The Mail and Calendar app lets you bring all your emails, calendars, and files together in one place, including those from third-party email and file storage providers. When you add an account to the Mail and Calendar app, your emails, calendar items, files, contacts, and other account settings will automatically sync across your device and Microsoft servers. To set up an account, you must provide the app with your account credentials (username and password), which will be sent to the third-party provider's server. If your account is provided by a business (such as a work account), the account owner may have certain policies and controls in place that could affect your use of the app—for example, multi-factor authentication or the ability to remotely wipe your device. The app also provides location-based services, such as weather information in your calendar. You can delete an account, change the data synced from your account, or disable access to your device's features, such as your location and camera, at any time.

The Windows Operator Messages app (formerly Windows Mail) receives and displays SMS messages related to your mobile carrier account regarding your data plan (for example, your billing and data limits) on your PC or device. These messages are stored locally on your device. You can also access, view, and delete these messages from your device. This app uses your device's features, such as Contacts.

The Clock app. The Clock app is your hub for time management and focus on Windows. When users sign in with their Microsoft account, they can enable Microsoft To Do, a cloud-connected experience. When a user enables Focus Sessions in Microsoft To Do, session data is stored locally, and you can

clear it by going to the Clock settings page. Additionally, Focus Sessions support connecting to Spotify accounts to listen to ambient audio.

Microsoft Journal. Microsoft Journal is a Windows app specifically designed for stylus-enabled touch devices, such as tablets and 2-in-1 devices. It offers users a free, personal note-taking experience. The app leverages artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning to better recognize your handwriting by processing data locally on your device. Users with a Microsoft 365 subscription can access their M365 calendar and contacts within the app. Journal also allows you to access your device's photo library, camera, and microphone so you can add photos to a notebook. Learn more about the Journal app [here](#).

Microsoft PC Manager. Available in select regions, PC Manager is a desktop tool designed to improve your PC's performance. At your request, PC Manager will scan your device and allow you to delete unnecessary or temporary files, optimize the cache, stop or recover from unauthorized changes, or use other features to improve your PC's performance.

PC Manager blocks pop-ups based on ad-blocking rules and pop-ups selected by you via a custom block. If you agree to join the "Microsoft PC Manager Pop-up Plan," when you block pop-ups via custom blocking, you can help us improve Microsoft PC Manager's pop-up management functionality by taking screenshots of the pop-up and sending them to Microsoft. Microsoft does not collect any information other than the screenshots, the Windows title, and the Windows class. Screenshots are kept only for a short time and then regularly deleted. You can manage your pop-up plan preferences through PC Manager settings. The PC Manager feedback feature may also process personal data if you include it in the feedback you provide to Microsoft. User feedback is regularly deleted after processing.

Circle to Act. Circle to Act is a service offered by PC Manager in select markets, with tools such as Screenshot Tool, Text Extraction, Translation, and Smart Copy. To enable the Smart Copy feature, screenshots you upload during use may be processed by Microsoft in data centers located outside your geographic location. For Text Extraction and Translation, screenshots captured during use are transmitted to Microsoft Azure, operated and managed by Microsoft or our local operating partners within your region. These screenshots are processed locally, and the results are returned to you upon completion. Microsoft does not retain any image or text data you

submit or the results provided, except when required to comply with legal obligations.

Snipping Tool. The Snipping Tool uses your microphone and image library to capture and store screenshots and screen recordings. The Snipping Tool includes a text action feature, which uses built-in Optical Character Recognition (OCR) support. You can select and copy text directly from images using OCR. Items copied from the Snipping Tool are also copied to your Clipboard. If you enable Clipboard History on multiple devices, copied content can be used seamlessly across different devices. Users can manage their Clipboard and screenshot preferences through Windows settings.

Voice Recorder app. The Voice Recorder app is designed to capture audio through your microphone in various scenarios. While recording, you can mark key moments to easily locate important sections later. You can also trim, adjust volume levels, or apply other edits as needed and play back your recordings. Your recordings are automatically saved and stored in your Documents folder for easy access, and you can share your recorded audio with friends and family.

Microsoft Clipchamp. Microsoft Clipchamp is a video editor that lets you combine videos, images, and audio files, add text and effects, and then save the finished video to your device or your personal OneDrive via your Microsoft account. You can allow Clipchamp to access your camera and microphone to record videos directly from your device. Clipchamp will collect your approximate location to provide a better experience, for example, to help you choose the display language.

Media Player. Media Player is the default built-in media player in Windows. When you open a media file, Media Player plays its contents. When you open Media Player, it reads the contents of your Music Library and Videos folders to populate its own Music Library and Videos Library pages within Media Player to help you organize, view, and play media content.

To enhance your music playback experience, Media Player automatically attempts to display artist and album artwork for the content you're playing and content in your music library. To provide this information, Media Player sends a request to Microsoft containing standard device data, such as your device's IP address, device software version, regional and language settings,

and a content identifier. You can disable this feature in the app's Settings page.

Movies and TV shows. Microsoft Movies & TV lets you rent or buy movies and TV episodes and play them on your device.

To help you discover content that may interest you, Movies & TV will collect data on the movies and TV shows you watch, including viewing time and ratings you give.

Movies & TV can also display and play local video files stored on your PC. To do this, it needs access to the video library on your device.

Legacy Windows Media Player. You can use Legacy Windows Media Player to play CDs and other digital content, such as video, audio, and image files, rip CDs, and manage your media library. To enhance your experience, the player displays associated media information, such as album titles, track titles, album art, artist, and composer. To provide additional media details, Legacy Windows Media Player can send a request to Microsoft that includes standard system information, a media content identifier, and existing media information from your library, including any edits or entries you've made, so that Microsoft can recognize the track and return other available information.

Legacy Windows Media Player also lets you play streaming content over a network by communicating with streaming media servers, which are typically operated by non-Microsoft content providers. While streaming media, the player may send a log to the streaming media server or web server containing details such as the connection time, IP address, operating system version, Legacy Windows Media Player version, player ID, date, and protocol. To protect your privacy, the player ID sent by Legacy Windows Media Player is unique to each session.

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Windows Hello

Windows Hello provides instant access to your devices through biometric authentication. If you enable it, Windows Hello uses unique points or features extracted from your face, fingerprint, or iris and stored on your device as a template to identify you, but it does not store the actual image of your face,

fingerprint, or iris. The biometric verification data used when you sign in does not leave your device and remains there until you delete it. After a significant period of Windows Hello inactivity, you will be asked to confirm that you want to continue storing your biometric verification data. You can delete biometric verification data in Settings. Learn more about [Windows Hello](#) .

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Windows Search

Windows Search lets you search your content and the web from a single place. If you choose to use Windows Search to search for "your items," it will provide results for items in your personal OneDrive, your OneDrive for Business (if enabled), other supported third-party cloud storage providers, and on your device. If you choose to use Windows Search to search the web or get search suggestions with Windows Search, your search results will be powered by Bing, and we will use your search query as described in the [Bing](#) section of this privacy statement. [Learn more about searching in Windows](#) .

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Entertainment services and related services

Entertainment services and related services such as Xbox, the Microsoft Store, and MSN offer rich experiences and give you access to a variety of content, apps, and games. We collect and use your information based on how you use these services to enhance your experience—for example, we collect your unique identifiers, information about how you interact with these services, the people you chat with, the content you upload, and the products you search for and purchase. For more information about these services, their features, and how they use data, see below.

Xbox

The Xbox network is Microsoft's online gaming and entertainment service, comprised of software that enables online experiences across various

platforms. This service allows you to search for and play games, view content, and connect with friends on Xbox and other social and gaming networks.

When you sign up for an Xbox profile, we assign you a Gamertag (public nickname) and a unique identifier. When you sign in to Xbox devices, apps, and services, the data we collect about your usage is stored using your credentials. Depending on your jurisdiction, you may be required to verify your age or identity to access certain services or features. If we ask you to verify your age or identity, please refer to the accompanying notice for details about the data collected and its use, as well as information about our third-party verification provider. In some cases, we consider the age of your account and age signals we receive from operating systems or app stores to better determine your age. If we are unable to verify your age or identity, we may need to adjust your settings or your access to certain features.

Children under 13, or a different age depending on your jurisdiction, need parental or guardian consent to create an Xbox profile and use the Xbox Network. When you set up an Xbox profile for your child, you sign in with your own Microsoft account to confirm that you are an adult organizer in your family group.

Xbox consoles are devices that let you find, play, and use games, movies, music, and other digital entertainment. When you sign in to an Xbox experience (in apps or on a console), we also assign a unique identifier to your device. For example, when your Xbox console is connected to the internet and you sign in to the console, we identify the console and the version of the console's operating system you're using.

The data we collect about your use of Xbox services, games, apps, and consoles includes:

- When you sign in to or sign out of Xbox, the purchases you make and the content you obtain are recorded.
- The games you play and the apps you use, your progress in games, your achievements, your playtime per game, and other game statistics.
- Performance data from Xbox consoles, Xbox Game Pass and other Xbox applications, the Xbox network, connected devices and your network connection, including software and hardware errors.
- The content you add, upload, or share via the Xbox network, including text, images, and videos you capture in games and apps.

- Social activity, including chat data and interactions with other players, and the connections you make (friends added and people who follow you) on the Xbox network.

If you sign in to use Xbox on another device that can access the Xbox network and that device includes a storage device (hard drive or memory unit), usage data will be stored on the storage device and sent to Microsoft the next time you sign in to Xbox, even if you played offline.

The data we collect allows us to provide you with our services and personalized experiences. This includes connecting you to games, content, and services, as well as showing you offers, discounts, and recommendations. To change your settings for these recommendations, visit the [Xbox online security and privacy settings](#) page .

We collect limited information about children, including their name, date of birth, email address, and region. When you create your child's Xbox profile, you consent to Microsoft collecting, using, and sharing their information, including personal data, according to its Xbox Network privacy and communication settings. Your child's privacy settings start at the most restrictive level by default.

Camera and microphone . When using Xbox, you can use device features such as the microphone, camera, and screen recording to enhance your gaming experience.

Xbox Diagnostic Data . Diagnostic data falls into two categories: required and optional. If your child uses an Xbox console, only the data required for diagnostics is sent to Microsoft to help ensure Xbox security and performance. The collection of optional diagnostic data is disabled for child accounts. For more information, see the Diagnostic Data section.

Learn more about [managing optional data sharing settings](#) .

Game Captures . Players in a multiplayer session can record video clips (game clips) and capture screenshots of their game display. Game clips and screenshots from other players may capture your gamertag and in-game character during that session. If a player captures game clips, they may also capture audio conversations, depending on their settings.

Captioning . During a real-time Xbox chat ("group"), players can enable a speech recognition feature that allows them to view the conversation as text.

If a player enables this feature, all voice communication in the group is captioned for that player. Microsoft uses the resulting text data to caption the conversation for players who need it. This data may also be used to provide a safe gaming environment and enforce the Xbox Community Standards, as well as for the other purposes described in this statement.

Xbox data visible to others . Your gamertag, games, game stats, achievements, presence (whether you're currently signed in to Xbox Live), content you share, and other data about your Xbox Live activity can be viewed by:

- Other players connected to Xbox.
- Third-party service clients to whom you have linked your profile.
- Other services associated with Xbox (including those from partner companies).

For example, your gamertag and leaderboard scores are considered public and cannot be hidden. For other data, you can adjust your privacy settings on consoles and on [Xbox.com](https://www.xbox.com) to limit or block what is shared publicly or with friends.

On the Xbox Network, your child's online presence (set to "friends" by default), gamertag, game stats, and achievements are visible to other players. Depending on how you set your child's Xbox security settings, they may share information while playing or communicating with others on the Xbox Network. You can manage these [settings](#) to control what is shared.

Learn more about [Xbox online security and privacy settings](#) .

Xbox data is shared with game and app publishers and developers .

When you play an online game on Xbox or any app connected to the network via your Xbox console, PC, or mobile device, the publisher of that game or app has access to data to enable them to provide, support, and improve their product. This data includes your Xbox user ID, gamertag, limited account information such as country and age range, data about your in-game communications, Xbox app activity, gameplay (for example, your movements or the types of vehicles you use in a game), your presence on the Xbox network, time spent in a game or app, rankings, stats, player profiles, avatars or gamerpics, friends lists, activity feeds in official clubs you belong to, club memberships, and any content you create or submit in the game or app. To stop sharing game or app data with a publisher, remove their games

or apps from any device where you have them installed. Some publisher access to your data can be revoked at <https://microsoft.com/consent>

Third-party game and app publishers and developers have a separate and independent relationship with users, and their collection and use of personal data is subject to their own privacy policies. You should carefully review their policies to understand how they use your data. You can find their policies on the game or app details pages in the Microsoft Store.

If you would like to learn more, please see [Data sharing with games and applications](#).

AI-enhanced features. Xbox offers optional AI-powered features, including our virtual support agents and Game Assist. To provide a response, these AI-enhanced features use your voice or text query, publicly available support articles, and other relevant data described in the "Personal data we collect" section or within the feature itself. Additional privacy settings are available in some Xbox AI-enhanced features, including Game Assist. You can view, export, or delete your Game Assist conversations in the Copilot section of the [Microsoft Privacy Dashboard](#).

Parental controls. You can use the [Xbox Family Settings](#) app to manage your child's experience on the Xbox Network, including spending in the Microsoft and Xbox stores, viewing your child's Xbox activity, and setting age ratings and screen time limits. Xbox-specific Family Safety settings apply on the Xbox console or via Xbox on PC or mobile device, but may not apply on other platforms.

To learn more about managing Xbox profiles, see [Xbox online security and privacy settings](#).

For more information about Microsoft's collection of data from children, including Xbox, please see the [Children's Data Collection](#) section of this privacy statement.

Security. In order to ensure a secure gaming environment within the Xbox network and to enforce Xbox Community Standards, we may collect and review voice, text, images, videos, and in-game content (such as game clips you upload, your conversations, and your posts in clubs and games).

Preventing Cheating and Fraud. Providing a fair gaming environment is important to us. We prohibit cheating, hacking, account theft, and any other

unauthorized or fraudulent activity when you use an Xbox online game or any network-connected application on your Xbox console, PC, or mobile device. To detect and prevent cheating and fraud, we may use anti-fraud and fraud prevention tools, applications, and other technologies. These technologies may create digital signatures (called "hashes") using certain information collected from your Xbox console, PC, or mobile device, and how you use that device. This may include information about your browser, device, activities, game identifiers, and operating system.

Legacy .

- **Xbox 360.** This Xbox console collects limited diagnostic data required to ensure your console continues to function as intended when using a console connected to the Xbox network.
- **Kinect .** The Kinect sensor is a combination of a camera, microphone, and infrared sensor that allows you to use movement and voice to control gameplay in supported titles. If you would like to learn more about Kinect, please see the [Privacy and Kinect Xbox](#) section .

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Microsoft Store

Microsoft Store is an online service, accessible via digital storefronts on the web, PC, Xbox consoles and the Xbox app, which allows you to browse, download, purchase, rate and view apps, games, subscriptions, additional content and in-app add-ons, as well as other digital content for devices such as PCs, tablets, Xbox consoles, mobile devices and others.

We collect information about your interactions with the Microsoft Store, including the products you browse, search for, view, add to wish lists or shopping carts, acquire, subscribe to, purchase, install, update, use, delete, uninstall, or for which you request customer support; your product display settings and preferences; and any ratings, reviews, or issue reports you submit. Your Microsoft account is linked to your ratings and reviews, and the name and/or image associated with your Microsoft account may appear with any reviews you post. The Microsoft Store also uses your device's regional

settings to deliver relevant content and features, and your device identifier to manage product rights linked to your device. Depending on your jurisdiction, you may be required to verify your age to view or obtain certain age-restricted content on the Microsoft Store. If we ask you to verify your age, please see the accompanying notice for details on the data collected and its use, as well as information about our third-party verification provider.

Permissions for Microsoft Store apps . Many apps you install from the Microsoft Store use specific hardware and software features on your device, which may require access to your data. For example, a photo editing app might access your device's camera to let you take photos or access photos or videos stored on your device, and a restaurant guide might use your location to recommend nearby restaurants. Information about the features an app uses is provided on its product description page in the Microsoft Store.

Many of the features used by apps installed from the Microsoft Store can be enabled or disabled in your device's privacy settings. On Windows, you can choose which apps can use a particular feature. Go to **Start > Settings > Privacy or Privacy & Security** , select the feature, and then adjust your app's permissions.

App updates . For security reasons, the Microsoft Store automatically checks for app updates, then downloads and installs them so you always have the latest versions. You can disable this feature in your Microsoft Store settings. The Microsoft Store only updates apps installed from the Microsoft Store, not those installed from other sources. If an updated app requests new access to certain features, such as your location, you'll be asked for your consent. You can see the hardware and software features an app uses by viewing its product description page in the Microsoft Store.

All personal data that an application collects and uses is subject to the application developer's privacy policy, which the developer must provide via a link on the application's product description page in the Microsoft Store.

Acquiring content from sources other than the Microsoft Store . Some Microsoft computing environments, such as Windows, may allow you to use third-party sources, such as third-party apps, app stores, or websites, to browse, search, acquire, purchase, download, or install apps, games, and other digital content. The privacy information described here does not apply to your use of or acquisitions from these third-party sources.

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MSN

MSN (formerly known as Microsoft Start or Microsoft News) is a content service that includes news, weather, sports, and finance. The MSN app is available on various platforms, including iOS and Android. The MSN service is also integrated into other Microsoft services, such as the Microsoft Edge browser and widgets on Windows.

When you install the MSN, MSN Weather, or Microsoft News apps, we collect data that tells us whether the app was installed correctly, the installation date, the app version, and other data about your device, such as your operating system and browser. This data is collected regularly to help us determine the number of app users and identify performance issues associated with different app versions, operating systems, and browsers. When you use the Weather app, we use your location to provide you with relevant weather content.

We also collect data about how you interact with MSN content, such as how often you use it and which articles you view, to provide you with relevant content. MSN offers an enhanced experience when you sign in with your Microsoft account, including the ability to personalize your interests and favorites. We use your location to provide you with relevant content, such as local weather and news. You can manage personalization through MSN and Bing settings, as well as through settings in other Microsoft services, including MSN. We also use the data we collect to provide you with advertisements that may be of interest to you. You can opt out of interest-based advertising through the ad links in MSN or by visiting the [Microsoft opt-out page](#).

Previous versions of MSN Finance allowed you to access personal financial information from third-party financial institutions. MSN Finance only displays this information and does not store it on our servers. Your login credentials for accessing your financial information from third parties are encrypted on your device and are not sent to Microsoft. These financial institutions, as well as any other third-party services you may access through MSN services, are subject to their own terms and privacy policies.

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Windows Mixed Reality

Windows Mixed Reality lets you enable a virtual reality experience that immerses you in apps and games. Mixed Reality uses a compatible headset camera, microphone, and infrared sensor, allowing you to use movement and voice to control gameplay and navigate within apps and games.

Microsoft collects diagnostic data to troubleshoot problems, keep Mixed Reality on Windows up to date, maintain its security, and ensure its proper functioning. Diagnostic data also allows us to improve Mixed Reality and related Microsoft products and services, based on the diagnostic data settings you have chosen for your device. [Learn more about Windows diagnostic data](#) .

Mixed Reality also processes and collects data specifically related to Mixed Reality experiences, such as:

- Mixed Reality maps the distances between your body's joints to create a representation of you. If you are connected to the internet, we collect these numerical values to activate and enhance your experience.
- Mixed Reality also detects specific hand movements designed to perform simple system interactions (such as navigating menus, panning/zooming, and scrolling). This data is processed on your PC and is not stored.
- Headset microphones enable voice commands to control games, applications, or search terms. [Learn more about voice data collection](#) .
- Windows Mixed Reality can also be used for audio and video communications.